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PUBLICAÇÕES
DO
CLUB VINTE DE SEPTEMBRO

III
HISTÓRIA
DA
REPUBLICA RIOGRANDENSE

translated from Portuguese by

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and

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History of the Rio-Grandense Republic

A Revised English Reading Edition

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This work is yet another effort in the direction of the ideas which I set forth and maintained in *The Federal Republic*. It is my conviction, strengthened more and more by study and meditation, that the most important revolutions which once shook the country, and whose ideal has not yet been satisfied, had as their principal cause the necessity of

establishing the rational system of federation, which may also be called the system of liberty, because liberty is order in accordance with the prescriptions of nature. The Rio-Grandense revolution, which resulted in the republic, is in this sense the most characteristic.

I therefore found myself faced with a double labor: besides that of recounting the facts, I had also to make plain their character. The narrowness of the time at my disposal for the composition of this first volume compelled me to send it to press before it fully satisfied my wishes, especially with regard to the narration of events. I was writing for the Club Vinte de Setembro, which had to present the work publicly on a fixed day.

For this reason I have called this edition preparatory. I hope very soon to be able to issue the definitive one, with the advantage that I shall already be able to make use, for it, of the corrections which competent persons may make to this. Only in this way can one obtain a passable history of a series of events as tangled as it is still unknown.

Nevertheless, I believe that I already advance many things which my predecessors had not yet said, because, besides having at my disposal their materials, I also had recourse to original documents of the highest importance and to certain truthful reports from persons who witnessed the facts. In this respect I received great assistance from General Portinho, the most illustrious survivor of the Rio-Grandense republicans, who, besides a large number of written documents of every kind, also furnished me with precious information concerning events in which he took

part or which passed before his eyes. On a smaller scale, many other citizens, some of them contemporaries of the republic, rendered me real assistance. It is for the volumes that will follow this one that these contributions have helped me most. Yet from this moment I record here my gratitude to them all.

Of works already published, I made principal use of the excellent monograph by Judge Araripe, a work of great merit, because it is a true construction out of elements which had been dispersed and disconnected. Although I find myself in fundamental disagreement with the author's ideas, and even with regard to the accuracy of certain facts, I must confess that in his book I learned more than anywhere else, besides having drunk from it the inspiration to write my own.

I was also much served by several works published in the daily press, such as those of Dr. Ramiro Barcellos, C. von Koseritz, and M. L. do Nascimento. This last gentleman also honored me with some personal information of high value. In general, the other sources are cited in the course of the work.

All that I have affirmed is based upon data of great solidity; but I resorted to citations only when it seemed to me that the question might offer occasion for controversy, or when, in spite of everything, I did not possess unshakable certainty.

One favor I expect from whoever reads this book and is versed in the knowledge of its subject: that he send me

the observations he may make concerning any inaccuracy contained in it. The best course would be to take the notes in the margin itself. Address: São Paulo.

There are many people, particularly in Rio Grande do Sul, who possess a great number of papers from the time of the republic and keep them unused and condemned to loss; yet those papers, in more diligent hands, would be of the greatest profit. I do not hesitate to venture a request to all such persons, chiefly to those who, out of patriotism, may wish to assist in the construction of the history of the glorious republic. Those who do not wish to part with their documents may merely lend them for a time.

Still others keep present in memory many episodes of various kinds that occurred in that period, and possess sufficient ability to describe them. These too would render an inestimable service by sending their information. In these matters everything is useful, everything is interesting, from the smallest adventure to the most resounding event.

Rio, August 1882.

A. B.

Chapter I

I undertake to write the history of the Rio-Grandense Republic: a brief and ephemeral state, raised at the far southern extremity of Brazilian territory, whose tumultuous existence, constantly harried by the arms of the Empire, did not succeed in passing beyond its period

of formation. Never did bravery, constancy, and civic virtues, served by men of scant education, offer of themselves a more surprising spectacle than in that struggle of nearly ten years, which calls up to the historian's mind the traditional tenacity of the ancient peoples.

Numerous and varied were the revolutions that agitated the first days of the Brazilian nation, from north to south; none of them, however, gave it such serious labor in repression, none demanded such considerable sacrifices, none placed national integrity in such imminent danger as the Rio-Grandense revolution. Powerful causes, therefore, must have moved the spirit of the insurgent province, causes capable of determining the exceptional energy of its pronouncement.

Carried away by the fatal habit of attributing everything to the exclusive influence of individuals and nothing to the indefectible laws according to which the historical movement is carried out, the writers who have so far occupied themselves with the Rio-Grandense revolution seek its causes in isolated and immediate facts which, before a more exacting and more rational inquiry, would in their turn require a second and longer explanation. Diverging fundamentally from a method as convenient as it is barren, I shall seek to sketch, together with the historical filiation of the series of events whose narration I propose, the causes which seem to me to explain its origin and prolongation.

No one today can fail to recognize the efficacious influence exercised upon a people by the whole set of physical

circumstances that surround it: the cosmic milieu. And if this fact had not already assumed the character of an accepted and proclaimed law, the example of Rio Grande would still be of great profit, for there the habits and tendencies of the inhabitants were from the outset sensibly adapted to the specific nature of the milieu.

Rio Grande do Sul occupies a broad zone of about three thousand square leagues in surface, bordered for a great part by the Atlantic, which lies to the east, and by the great river Uruguay, which runs along the opposite side, seeking the waters of the Plata, into which it empties. Its astronomical position, analogous to that of the countries of southern Europe, lies between twenty-nine and thirty-three degrees of south latitude. This position, and the complete absence of high mountain chains and deep valleys, cause all winds to blow freely over the whole extent of the territory, with greatest vehemence always in the celebrated minuano, which comes from the direction of the point where the great American cordillera of the Andes gradually lowers and dies away.

From these circumstances derives the fact that in Rio Grande the seasons of the year are sharply defined and characterized. Winter is extremely cold; the more exposed places have at times reached freezing, the mass of ice resisting the action of the sun for three days and more without dissolving. In summer there sometimes reigns an unbearable heat, equal to the most intense heat of the tropics; autumn and spring display a paradisiacal temperature. The rains are abundant in winter and spring;

summer and autumn are, as a rule, dry. Vegetation accompanies this variability. There is not in Rio Grande the luxuriant monotony of the vegetable world observed in the intertropical regions of Brazil.

The soil of none of the other Brazilian provinces can be compared with that of Rio Grande, whose nature and configuration make it, in relation to the rest of the country, what one might call a world apart. The province is naturally divided into two regions: that above and that below the mountain range, of almost equal size. Contrary to what some have written and many suppose, these two regions do not differ in that the first is mountainous and the second plain, for both are equally plain and broken. The difference lies in their height above sea level. The lower part rises, on average, about one hundred feet, with even one city, Rio Grande, not exceeding a height of twenty-eight inches; the upper part presents an average of fifteen hundred feet, with points such as the pass of Santa Victoria, near the headwaters of the Uruguay, which rise to thirty-two hundred feet.

The zone called *Cima da Serra* is a broad strip of land stretching between the Uruguay and the Serra do Mar. This range, which throughout the south of the country runs within sight of the ocean, bends northwest on entering Rio Grande, crosses the province in a western direction, and expires beside the banks of the Uruguay, at the point where that great river already turns its waters markedly toward the south. The Serra do Mar, which in this course takes various local names and is known in the

province by the generic denomination of Serra Geral, is like a step between the upper and lower parts. There the ground rises and no longer sinks. Crossing it, the traveler at once feels this fact when, after walking about six kilometers in continual ascent, he finds himself before an immense plain, whose long hills unfold and succeed one another infinitely, until sight becomes wholly powerless to reach them. The fields above the range are clear and of most beautiful aspect; the hills extraordinarily extensive, some of them forming gentle undulations three kilometers in length; at intervals, leafy groves, round and shadowy woods, display upon imperceptible depressions of the terrain the most poetic effects. Being the highest region, it is also the coldest of the province, although it is the one that lies nearest the tropic.

The lower part lies between the ocean, the range, the Uruguay, the Quaraí, and the Jaguarão. Its aspect is highly variable: covered with sand dunes and innumerable lagoons in a narrow strip more than four hundred kilometers long along the sea coast; absolutely level throughout almost the whole basin of the great rivers of the Platine system; now level, now mountainous in the center, whence radiates a great number of small ranges that are nothing more than buttresses of the Serra Geral, and where the hills present more modest dimensions than those of the high region. It is from above the range that there descend, in great part, the waters of the largest rivers of the lower section, the Uruguay, the Ibicuí, the Jacuí, and the Taquari, the last two crossing the range through a basaltic bed, narrow, deep, and strongly broken.

Some travelers and observers understand that, in an epoch relatively not remote, even long after the submarine uplift which produced the highest parts of the soil, the ocean beat at the base of the Serra Geral, as still happens farther north, and afterward slowly withdrew toward the east and south, as firm and elevated lands were formed upon the beaches by means of alluvia or sedimentary layers. The truth is that the composition and aspect of the soil do incline one toward such a supposition. Future observations, regularly carried out, will certainly come to establish the truth on this point, for mere reports from incompetent persons do not suffice to fix it.

I still remember that, while traveling along the small range of Caverá, between the present municipalities of Alegrete and Rosário, a range completely stripped of woods and covered only with grass, I was profoundly impressed by the singular disposition of parallel and horizontal lines which all the hills presented at the same height and on the face that looked toward the floodplain. It seems that the constant action of the waters must have carved those parallel marks in times which only very deep investigations could approximately determine. Geikie notes similar facts observed in the mountains of Europe; and, only a few years ago, a scientific commission sent by the Argentine government to northern Patagonia was led to analogous conclusions, as may be seen from its report published in 1881. Perhaps this is the explanation for the existence of the broad and beautiful plains of Rio Grande, as well as of the countries that extend through the south of America, across almost the whole basin of the Plata and beyond.

Compared with any of the other provinces, that of Rio Grande is very poor in respect to large vegetation. Great forests are rare there, and none of those that exist equals in vigor and majesty the extraordinary virgin woods of northern Brazil. The primordial conditions for the fertility of the soil are heat and humidity. These two conditions exist in a very insufficient degree in Rio Grande: its very southern latitude subtracts from the rays of the sun a great part of their heat, and the prevailing winds, ordinarily harsh and strong, blowing in all directions, dry out the soil. There is no mountain range, no barrier, to arrest the action of the winds, compelling them to retreat and fall back, dissolved into moisture, upon the ground, as happens with the Andes and the eastern ranges of Brazil. Only upon the slope of the Serra Geral, in the neighborhood of the hilly lands of the upper Uruguay and about the headwaters of that river, do these conditions combine in such a manner as to cause great and true forests to rise there, of useful and abundant timbers, such as the Castelhana wood, the Portuguese wood, and others at various points of the same zone. The moisture inherent to the banks of rivers and streams also causes these to be bordered throughout their length by a fringe, broader or narrower, of good and vigorous woodland, except where the ground is so sandy as to verge upon sterility.

Yet such is the happy composition of the lands that, notwithstanding the unfavorable situation in which Rio Grande is placed with respect to atmospheric phenomena, its soil still contains a prodigious fecundity. The sandy adjacencies of the sea beaches form an exception, being

ordinarily almost absolutely sterile; but even these may, in future times, be transformed by the art of agriculture, as has been done in analogous places in Portugal, in certain maritime counties of England, and as is now being done in the environs of the city of Rio Grande. All the other lands of the province which are not covered with woods are embroidered with very extensive green meadows, over which innumerable species of grasses spread themselves, and the best of them, forming the most succulent pastures known. To form an idea of the exuberant intrinsic power of nourishment which the soil transmits to these pastures, it is enough to consider that for nearly two centuries the same wool-bearing, horse, and cattle breeds, without the least crossing, have fed exclusively upon them and still today display beautiful specimens. In less favored regions, the lack of crossing would have determined a fatal and rapid degeneration in less than half that time. What, then, will the Rio-Grandense plains not produce in pastoral industry when methodical selection, with the progress of the times, brings aid and stimulus to the blind spontaneity of nature?

The fitness of the lands for agriculture is notable, being able abundantly to cover consumption and still to produce a remarkable surplus for export on a large scale. Cereals, maize and wheat in the high places, and rice in the low and marshy ones, thrive there admirably. In short, there is no article of primary necessity in this branch which the province cannot produce, and from which it could not create an extensive commerce.

Its natural riches are incalculable. Besides the gold and silver which in various places form precious veins, all the minerals of most fruitful utility are found in prodigious abundance. Marble of all colors and qualities, from black to the purest white, which has been compared to the best of Carrara, exists in truly inexhaustible quarries, together with other products of the same kind. Iron and coal, those two most powerful auxiliaries of industry, form immense deposits. Especially in the valley of Candiota, where iron also is common in its varied compositions, and where coal in repeated places comes to the surface of the soil, the mineral riches assume a fantastic character.

Nothing is lacking to Rio Grande do Sul.

It is a land that can live in luxury exclusively from its own resources. Everything there is favorable to civilization and to progress, even those circumstances which at first sight appear to be an obstacle.

Such was the theater, described as briefly as possible, in which the long and obstinate struggle was engaged, of which this book will be a pale and imperfect narration. Whoever was born and lived in that land, where nature herself has a singular aspect of masculine generosity, cannot fail to love it with a fanatical love. The adoration of the Rio-Grandense for his native soil has already become proverbial, as has the pride, often imprudent yet always most natural, with which he places it above all its sister provinces. There are lands of this sort, which exercise such influence over their children that they come to identify them with themselves. From the adaptation of

a people to this whole set of surrounding circumstances there is born for it a corresponding nature. The Rio-Grandense character had this origin.

It is, therefore, in the first place, in physical nature, in the ensemble of circumstances that constitute the cosmic milieu, that one finds the first reason, the initial cause, I shall not say only of the revolution, but also of the manner in which it was carried out. To bring out the sanction of this assertion, it will suffice to combine the primordial circumstances with one another, and afterward with the supervening facts that came to collaborate with them. This is the subject of the pages that follow.

II

The elements from which the population of Rio Grande was formed differ greatly from those which gave origin to the other territories of the country. The first settlers were, in truth, Portuguese; but Portuguese who were no longer, in their turn, the same as those who had previously immigrated to America. They were Azoreans, and in the Azores the primitive Lusitanian population had been modified under the influence of the milieu. It was a strong and persistent race, singularly predisposed to constitute a solid trunk for a new population. The Portuguese of the continent who came later found this original trunk already formed; and, joining themselves to it, could not fail to undergo its influence.

On the other hand there entered Paulistas and Mineiros, already likewise differentiated from the common original base, not only by the immediate influence of the milieu,

but also by the new kind of activity in which they had from the outset exercised themselves. The long and hazardous journeys, the remote explorations in which they were so constant, and which in the end became for them an inveterate habit, must have been of great consequence for the character of these peoples. And it was precisely by virtue of this habit, in many of those assiduous excursions, that the most adventurous among them came several times to Rio Grande and fixed themselves there in great number.

The Spanish contingent was not so insignificant as is generally supposed. The Spaniards dominated for long spaces of time a great part of the territory of the province; besides which, in reciprocal invasions, the two peoples visited one another on various occasions. In my view, the consideration of the traditional rivalry existing between them does not stand in the way, because political antagonisms have never disturbed matters of procreation. What offers a serious impediment to the contact of two races, at least in the first times, is the material or moral repugnance which one feels with respect to the other. This fact, which could not occur between Portuguese and Spaniards, races that approach one another at many points of affinity, I judge to have had some influence in Rio Grande with regard to the crossing of whites with Africans and indigenous peoples.

Brazil was already more or less colonized throughout when Rio Grande began to be peopled, and it was still some time after the first nuclei were established that the African traffic began to flow on an appreciable scale toward the lands of the south. The infamous commerce

could not be carried on there with great advantage: first of all, the difficult and dangerous entrance of the bar, where there was not yet a regular pilotage service, and afterward the poverty of the inhabitants, which did not permit a broad outlet for the black merchandise, must have been obstacles of considerable weight. Thus, by the time of the revolution of the province, although Ethiopian blood had already penetrated into the mass of the population, it was not, however, in sufficient quantity to impress upon it a decisive influence.

The Indian entered still less. It is true that this race tolerably peopled the territory when the first explorers and settlers arrived there; but before the white population radiated outward from the first centers and came into contact with it, supervening events changed the order of things. The Jesuits, penetrating by the Rio da Prata and everywhere with their fine sagacity and foresight, established themselves on both banks of the Uruguay, and chiefly on the left, laying the foundations of the famous Guaranitic Empire. Thither, by using their most effective resources of catechization, they gathered, one may say, the whole indigenous population that wandered through the interior of the territory. To give credence to this fact, it is enough to reflect that in the second half of the eighteenth century, when Gomes Freire de Andrade, in combination with the Spanish army, undertook to dislodge them by force of arms, they succeeded in placing in the field against the allied generals an army of twelve thousand men, while it is certain that throughout the province the indigenous

population did not reach the number of some twenty-five thousand souls at the arrival of the Jesuits.

The administrative system employed by the Jesuits with their Indians of the Missions is well known. In the Seven Peoples, entrance was absolutely and categorically forbidden to whites, whom the priests did not neglect to depict as atheists, possessed by demons, and endowed with all the ugly qualities that imagination and calculation suggested to them. In an official letter addressed to his government, Gomes Freire, sketching this Jesuit doctrine, wrote: "...the prisoners taken at Rio Pardo, being asked for what reason they cut off the heads of the Portuguese when they killed them, said that their blessed Fathers assured them that the Portuguese, even if many wounds were given them, were so possessed by demons that many of them rose again, and that the safest course was to cut off their heads." It is understood that, with these habits, the crossing of Indians with whites would be exceedingly difficult.

In the war against the Spanish and Portuguese armies, the indigenous people, who hurled themselves toward death with the savage courage of fanaticism and ignorance, were extraordinarily decimated. The few who survived preserved the tradition, the customs inculcated by their expelled directors. During the Castilian domination of some forty years, the same system of seclusion was maintained, and the same tendency remained toward the decrease of the population; for besides other reasons that existed for this, the Spaniards, less interested, no longer put into

practice certain empirical rules discovered by the Jesuits which provoked, on the part of those they directed, an astonishing prolificacy.(1) When, in 1801, the celebrated José Borges do Canto conquered the Missions for the Portuguese crown, he already found the population reduced to fourteen thousand individuals. In 1822 the town of São Miguel, which at the time of that conquest had nineteen hundred inhabitants, had fallen to six hundred; São João, in those twenty-one years, fell from sixteen hundred to three hundred; São Lourenço from nine hundred and sixty to two hundred and fifty; Santo Ângelo from nineteen hundred and sixty to three hundred and fifty; São Luiz from twenty-three hundred and fifty to two hundred; São Nicolau from thirty-nine hundred and forty to two hundred and fifty; São Borja from thirteen hundred to four hundred; or, in summary, the whole population from 14,010 to 2,350.

The author of *Economic-Political Memoirs on the Public Administration of Brazil*, from whom I take these data, laments that even at the time when he was writing, 1823, “some governors of that district have opposed whites going there to trade, and even to establish themselves.” Even some time after the independence of Brazil, the Missions were separated from the province, forming an administrative section.(2) From these facts it follows by rigorous conclusion that, if later the aboriginal element cooperated in the formation of the Rio-Grandense population, at least in 1835, the epoch of the revolutionary pronouncement, the admixture of that factor was still negligible. And in fact there were few mestizos at that time. The Indians who

existed in the province were still, in almost their totality, pure caboclos. From them were formed regiments and companies of excellent cavalry, from which the republicans drew good profit, and the legalists still better.

- (1) The married Indians, and all, I believe, upon reaching a suitable age, were obliged by the priests to wake at five o'clock in the morning, but to remain in bed until six.
- (2) Each town has a Corregedor and other civil magistrates, or rather rural captains; the government appoints administrators for them, and a governor who watches over everything. The towns, far from prospering, diminish more and more. About three years ago a troop corps of four hundred Guaranis was drawn from there. Antônio José Gonçalves Chaves, *Memórias econômico-políticas*, p. 32. The author of this excellent work, printed in Oporto, is Antônio José Gonçalves Chaves, a Portuguese who lived in Pelotas, where he was a charqueador.

Fernandes Pinheiro, in his *Annals of the Captaincy of São Pedro*, attributes a preponderant influence among the original elements of the Rio-Grandense population to the "bad leaven" that soon entered into its mass, "the base of this consisting of the refuse of the Nation, of convicts, of immoral and banished women." But this idea, which must be rejected with respect to all Brazil, because the transported convicts could never have been in so great a number that such a leaven could preponderate, is especially false with regard to Rio Grande, where they were

imported in a very insignificant portion. The author of the *Memoirs*, who refutes Fernandes Pinheiro's assertion with great advantage, affirms that, although he lived seventeen years in Rio Grande, he does not remember more than two transported convicts having entered there, "one coming from Porto and the other from São Paulo." As for the customs of the inhabitants, maligned by Fernandes Pinheiro, he affirms that these, "far from being, as the *Annals* say, naturally fierce, fickle, thievish, and dissolute, are on the contrary honorable, upright, humane, hospitable, and modest; that on the estancias one lives very decently; the weaker sex shows no noticeable difference between the countryside and the towns: in general the women of the province are, besides beautiful, intelligent, affable, honest, virtuous, and charitable; and in these virtues those raised on the estancias do not yield to those of the towns." This writer attributes Fernandes Pinheiro's inaccuracies to the fact that he never left Porto Alegre "except for his country house." In fact, it is almost always incomplete observations that give rise to injustices such as these.

In summary, the Rio-Grandense population, and it must be noted that I refer to that which influenced the movement of 1835, is the immediate product of these principal factors: Azorean and Portuguese, Paulista and Mineiro, Spanish; the African and the autochthonous element exercised an almost null action; the great current of Portuguese emigration which, toward Rio Grande as toward all Brazil, directed itself, had there less effect than in other provinces, because it already found the original trunk formed and went on subordinating itself to it, by virtue of

the universal law of adaptation to the milieu. Its action was more energetic from another point of view: in the general direction, in administration, in government; and there I shall still have occasion to consider it before reaching the end of this chapter.

In any case, whether these observations are exact or not, what is real, what is undeniable because it is a fact, is that, whatever the forces may have been that acted at the beginning, from them there emerged as resultant a population of such plasticity that rapidly, in less than four generations, it adapted itself fully to the cosmic milieu into which it was cast and presented the most striking originality. This is the culminating fact, which I hold to be firm and unshakable. When the revolution of 1835 was preparing itself in the mind of the province, the province already possessed a character properly its own, with characteristic usages, customs, and tendencies. It was even the time of greatest originality: the natural forces had realized their complete evolution, and civilization had not yet modified their effects. The existence of the province dated from little more than a century, and it is true that this time is exceedingly narrow for the realization of a fact of this order, which regularly demands the course of many centuries. For that very reason, in order to reconcile principles with reality, it is necessary to consider the energetic properties and conditions of the milieu in which the new population was formed, and the particular dispositions, offered by its constitutive elements, for shaping themselves to that milieu.

One fact which stands out at the slightest observation is that in this work the ascendancy of surrounding nature over the population was very pronounced. All the peculiar characteristics of the people, all its habits, and the very type of physical constitution are in the most rigorous correlation with the particular circumstances of the milieu.

The astronomical position of the province makes its climate exceedingly cold, and the nature of the soil, completely unsheltered toward the seas of the south and toward the open and level regions of the Pampas, aggravates this circumstance still more, causing it to be easily and constantly visited by airs almost icy from the neighborhood of the pole. This temperature impresses a special tone upon the fiber of the inhabitant. Peoples who inhabit cold countries, when this phenomenon is not carried to excess, generally display a rigid and strong organization and acquire greater agility and persistence for the labors of life. The white race in particular presents these results; nor is there any other explanation for a great part of the merits of the Saxon race and of those which have affinity with it or are its branches. In Brazil, the differences which the various temperatures have been establishing from the equator southward are sensible and well known; but nowhere are they reflected so strikingly as in Rio Grande, where, moreover, other causes, as we shall see, combine with this one to construct a special type.

But the cold is not permanent. In summer, when the repeated displacements of the polar atmosphere cease, there ordinarily reigns, together with the great calms, a stifling

and distressing heat. By reason of the atmospheric purity, the rays of the sun become at times as ardent as if they did not fall obliquely upon the earth. This contrast of cold and heat, both carried to an exaggerated degree, accustoms the individual who endures such an alternation to resist with equal valor every sort of inclemency. Especially in the hardships of war, a man suffers bitterly from the action of a climate to which he was not habituated, or from the alternation of suns and rains, which produces an analogous effect. This cannot happen to the Rio-Grandense. It is known that the province furnishes an excellent soldier, in whom the courage with which he charges upon the enemy is not more admirable than the constancy with which he resists the hostilities of nature.

The aspect of the soil, as well as the kind of its productions, also acts decisively not only upon the physical constitution of the individual, but chiefly upon his moral attributes. Thus the inhabitant of the forest is generally timid and little spirited, as if he partook of the gloomy nature that surrounds him. Garibaldi, when he was serving his apprenticeship in arms in the service of the Rio-Grandense Republic, had occasion to observe, in the terrible retreat through the Serra das Antas, that the dwellers of those forests were almost all hostile to the republican cause and, above all, treacherous and cowardly, attacking from ambushes and fleeing after the insidious blow. This observation of the great general, which is found in his *Memoirs*, is very exact and of great reach. The man of the forest cannot have the same ideas, still less the same sentiments, as the man of the open plain. On the plain,

even those who have an innate tendency toward treachery cannot easily exercise it. In the dark thickets, on the contrary, the very aspect of nature awakens in man the germ, the itching of perverse inclinations. The valor of the spirit increases in proportion as it can act more unconfined and free; and nothing fills it so much with a grave joy and with the consciousness of its own strength and greatness as a great picture, a vast, broad, and smiling prospect of nature. The immense green plains of Rio Grande, leaving aside other results, must have been, by their aspect and beauty alone, an impulsive force of great weight, contributing to give to the soul of its inhabitants the excellent temper of which it is made.

Food in Rio Grande is solid, succulent, abundant, and absolutely free of principles injurious to health. Farinaceous foods, in general, have almost no use. Manioc flour itself, which is manufactured in large quantity, is consumed in a degree much inferior to that of the northern provinces.

Meat is eaten, and meat of the best, the freshest, and most substantial kind. Cattle are so abundant and exist spread throughout the whole province with such great prodigality that this excellent food belongs indistinctly to rich and poor. Bloody meat is devoured with the best of appetites; a piece of it thrown carelessly upon the fire and only toasted, this is the genuine churrasco, that typical dish of the gaúcho.

After each meal, and at every hour, one ingests, one after another, some dozens of gourds of bitter mate, *chimarrão*. The digestive, diuretic, and sudorific properties of mate

complete what the meat began. A strong expansive vigor is transmitted to the whole body, and thought, like every function, shares in the agility of the organs.

Modern science unanimously proclaims the importance that must be attached to food as a sociological factor. Already La Mettrie, the cheerful philosopher, companion and friend of the great Frederick, exalted the virtues, “the enormous power that there is in a meal,”(1) and attributed the particular character of the English to their habit of eating bloody meat. Upon more rational bases Taine(1) maintains this same opinion, and Buckle(2) expounds and fully justifies it with his habitual eloquent clarity. In Rio Grande the fact occurred in such a way as to produce its effects as energetically as possible. When the province was peopled, it was already stocked with cattle, which always, down to the present, exceeded by far the necessities of consumption and determined a considerable exportation. In the first times, moreover, as had to result from superabundance, the article was extremely cheap, indeed the cheapest, though the best, of all foodstuffs. As for mate, the same occurred: it was manufactured in the province itself, where there are inexhaustible and excellent *hervais*, and often by the consumer himself. The facility there was for the continuous action of this powerful agent, food, explains the rapidity with which its effects manifested themselves.

(1) *Man a Machine*, Chapter VII.

In provinces of the north, in Ceará and Piauí, for example, animal food is also found in broad abundance; but its

effects will inevitably be different, operating in a climate almost invariably torrid and upon the northerner, devourer of flour, tidbits, and irritants.

- (1) H. Taine, *History of English Literature*. (2) H. T. Buckle, *History of Civilization in England*.

In this sense, the clearest comparison that can be established is between the *caipira* of São Paulo and the *gaúcho* of Rio Grande. The *caipira*, who generally feeds on beans, cornmeal, and coffee, presents a valetudinarian aspect: dull complexion, slack and extinguished gaze; he is bent, yellow, toothless. The *gaúcho* is robust, ruddy, and muscular; he has a restless and penetrating gaze, white and strong teeth, a straight spine, the neck solidly planted upon broad athletic shoulders. Those who live in the cities degenerate, as a rule, from this type, whereas in the province of São Paulo this circumstance of residing in centers, or amid abundance, determines serious improvements. Leprosy, elephantiasis, as well as almost all cutaneous affections, are maladies unknown in Rio Grande.

Industry, comprehending under this denomination every kind of material activity of a people, furnishes in Rio Grande the exercises most appropriate for the development of the moral and physical faculties of individuals. It is determined, as always happens, by the very constitution of the milieu. Its insufficiency for great vegetation and, at the same time, the superior intrinsic qualities of the soil determined the existence of the compact grass that carpets the greater part of the province, natural pastures able to compete with the best in the world. From this resulted the

fact that the plains, over the whole extent of the territory, became covered, with an astonishing and inexplicable rapidity, by innumerable herds of varied species of live-stock. The nature of this element of industry, equally precious and easy of acquisition for all, produced these two facts: it more or less leveled the conditions of fortune, by the convergence of interests toward the same point, and provoked in all an equal activity in that confluence of interests.

Inertia is impossible in Rio Grande. Even the life which there is considered indolent and lazy is full of troubled activity. The labor of the estancias is reputed an amusement, and as such the gaúcho accepts it; yet there is no more barbarous and fiery toil than this, in which life itself is in danger at every moment: now in the horse-breaker, who, fixed upon his saddle, resists the terrible bucks of the wild colt; now in the field hand, who darts at loose rein, with dizzying speed, over lands riddled with holes and precipices; now in the lassoer, who fearlessly affronts, communicating to the horse the agility of his own body, the indomitable fury of the angry bull upon the height of a deserted hill. The making of a drove and its conduction to the charqueada can be compared only to the harsh labors of war. Whether it rains, whether the sun scorches, whether the cold whistling minuano blows, the labor does not cease. The gaúcho goes out at dawn to his fatigues and often returns from them only when night is closed. Not rarely he supports during the whole day a forced fast, and he is so habituated to these vicissitudes that he

almost always neglects to provide himself at home with the necessary cold provisions.

On the march, the cruelty of suffering is redoubled: to guard the drove, to enclose it, to subject it in its stampedes, to gather it when, by virtue of one of these accidents, it disperses in various and unknown directions, in continual danger of being crushed by the weight of his own horse or torn by the hoofs of the cattle in narrow passages where the drove, suddenly assailed by unexpected panic, moves rapidly and compactly in an immense mass, and does not retreat before efforts, shouts, and pistol shots. Such is the life of the great number of Rio-Grandenses who embrace the profession of drover. The service begins at the time when the rigor of the dog days reigns and always enters into the season of frosts, until the month of June. More or less similar are all the other modes of life. The gatherer of mate, who painfully watches the *carijo* through whole nights, and the cart-driver, who in his long and slow journeys struggles against the inclemencies and the hostilities of the terrain, have no life less varied, less active, or less laborious. The products of agriculture are carried by the producers themselves through the countryside in quest of exchange or sale for money. Commerce itself in the countryside is exercised by peddlers, who make prolonged excursions through it, conducting goods in carts and following in everything the inveterate habits of the inhabitants. Today this habit is modified, but it is not extinct.

All this, all these difficulties and bitternesses, are supported, I shall not merely say with resignation, but with heroic and sincere joy; and this constant labor, to which the nature of man grows accustomed and adjusts itself, hardens his organization and reflects analogous consequences in his character.

One observation which at this point must not be forgotten is that relative to the effects of the contagion which the neighboring Hispano-American peoples exercised upon the province of Rio Grande from the earliest times. This contagion, of which for the present I treat only as a co-determinant of the specific type of the province, exerted itself in two most efficacious ways: by the infusion of Hispano-American blood into the Rio-Grandense group, and by the imitation of usages and customs. An opinion now very current even carries these facts to the exaggeration of considering them the sole factors of the Rio-Grandense character. Such is their importance.

Of the cooperation of race I have already treated in speaking of the formation of the population; the influence of usages and customs is of incontestable weight. The tendency toward imitation is natural to the whole human species, and in it resides in great part the explanation of the entire evolutionary movement of humanity. The more two peoples touch by common points of resemblance, the more decisive and patent are the effects of imitation. Rio-Grandenses and Hispano-Americans of the south inhabit, one may say, the same zone; for a long time there was not even a determined frontier line separating them; for

a long time considerable waves of one people and the other reciprocally invaded the neighboring dominions. Brazil once legally had as the extremity of the country the immense mouth of the Plata; the Hispano-Americans had already planted their boundary marks in the heart of Rio-Grandense territory and along the course of the Ibicuí. From this ebb and flow there remained considerable residues, to which the geographical similarity of the countries of the two peoples, and even the analogy of the races, lent transcendent importance. Thus are explained the similarities existing between the two in character, usages, customs, and even language. The differences, however, are more numerous than the similarities, which is very easy to understand in view of the initial diversity of the two peoples.

It was from this concurrence of circumstances, summarily set forth, the influence of climate, of the nature and aspect of the soil and of its consequent productive capacity, the plasticity of the original population, food, industry, contagion with the neighboring race, that there germinated and grew the distinctive type of the Rio-Grandenses, that vigorous and solid type which alone would suffice to explain the strange impetus of their revolution. Add to all this a countless number of other secondary causes awakened by the idea of these; consider the innate sentiment of pride and haughtiness which the contemplation of the beauties and superiority of a land he loves so much infuses into the Rio-Grandense, a land resplendent with marvels, predisposed to incline all spirits toward outbursts of poetic enthusiasm; consider the sentiment of independence

latent in each man, through the conviction in which all are held that the province, which contains within its bosom, in the most ample superabundance, everything necessary to life, has no need of bonds of subjection to a foreign element in order to preserve itself and progress; consider all these facts, all these sentiments acting constantly upon men for more than a century, reinvigorating themselves through persistence, transmitting themselves by heredity from generation to generation, ever more pronounced, ever more incisive, and one will understand without effort the nature and the effects of a movement that issued from the heart of this people, prepared in such a manner by energetic precedents.

III

In the relation existing between the province of Rio Grande and the nation against which it rebelled, the causes of the revolutionary fact must also be studied.

In this kind of inquiry, what first looms large is the difference, the profound divergence that is observed between the constitution of the whole and the constitution of the part, between Brazil and Rio Grande. Effectively, there is no province so diverse from the rest of the country as the province of Rio Grande, which, strictly speaking, has with any of its sisters no exact point of geographical or ethnographical coincidence. It seems to me that the preceding pages are sufficient to prove this.

What this natural order of things clearly required was that the institutions with which it should be clothed not be antagonistic to its character. Everywhere, a rational

system of political institutions ought to be no more than the reflection, the repercussion, if one may so speak, of the system of conditions upon which it is established. Now this was precisely what in Brazil was always ignored and denied, especially with regard to Rio Grande, and much more in the time of the Empire than in that of the colony. From this province, so characteristically original, our men intended, by the simple and ineffectual influx of legislation, to make a part in every respect equal and similar to the whole to which it was joined only by remote bonds of affinity. Like all the members of the country, it was tied to the center by the fatal bonds of unity ill understood. The law had the foolish intent of leveling that in which nature had established a wise and harmonious inequality.

When legislative force adjusts itself to that of nature, it is fruitful and salutary; it is like intelligence guiding and profiting from the aptitudes of the body. But when it enters into competition with nature, operating in the opposite direction, the victory, which must necessarily fall to nature, is all the more disastrous because it is unaided by conscious effort. The events of Rio Grande were a sad proof of this truth. A great example, whose eloquent lesson nevertheless seems not to have served, down to the present, those for whom it was destined. An organization based upon natural elements, a federative organization, to say everything, established at the opportune time, in which the great organs of this extraordinary country might freely exercise their proper functions, cooperating freely also for the life of the whole, would have parried the repeated blows that more than once were on the point

of cutting forever the thread of national integrity. Liberty is in everything a condition of life and, consequently, of order; they wished to substitute for it atrophying centralization; the result was what was seen: an energetic protest of nature.

Under colonial dominion, Rio Grande, which was the last section of the country to be colonized and which never properly formed part of any captaincy, always constituted an exception. The captains-general, exercising their authority in the name of the king, were absolute governors and independent in fact. The placement of the Rio-Grandense captaincy, whether in relation to the rest of the country or in relation to the Spanish colonies, guaranteed it this exceptional position. The conflicts between Portugal and Spain were joined and decided upon the frontiers of its territory. It was rather a strategic point than an administrative division. One can never overstate the reach of this circumstance in the formation of the Rio-Grandense character. The people became essentially warlike; the habits of a continual military agitation were strongly impressed upon its nature; and at the same time, the fact of defending its interests almost always with its own resources accustomed it still more to the idea of independence, already insensibly implanted in its spirit by the antecedents of which I have had occasion to speak. The people abominated the government of the captains-general, which was, in effect, arbitrary and cruel. When the regime changed through the independence of Brazil, the names of those authorities were remembered only with execration; but what is true is that, together with that harsh

tyranny, the faculties of the future province developed and the direction of its innate tendencies was fixed, and the very residue of hatreds and rancors left by the old system contributed to accentuate and define them with greater clarity.

The independence of Brazil came, and with it the political and administrative regime that still endures today without notable difference. The people experienced the explosive joy of one who frees himself from an unbearably distressing state. It believed itself in the presence of a solution of continuity between past and future, entering into a new era, pregnant with improvements, with liberty, and with progress. The spectacle of things, however, soon made it see that the new regime was no more than a prolongation of the old and detested one, that the modifications had been apparent. The province continued to be governed like the captaincy, with this single difference: that the government of the new metropolis was exercised more directly than that of the old, and precisely when it was less necessary, so that the evils of centralization, if they already existed, were aggravated still more.

To the general state of irritating discontent which these things produced was added the continual alarm in which, for some years, spirits lived, fearing a return to the colonial period. These suspicions were authorized by the conduct of the individual who seated himself upon the throne: Portuguese by birth, surrounded by Portuguese, and educated in the practices of absolutism, the only ones he knew. The first national assembly that met, the assem-

bly that should have dictated the political constitution of the state, had been dissolved by armed force through the direct intervention of the young emperor, absolutist and absolute, and its members expelled and persecuted. The entire country was agitated; everywhere commotions appeared on a greater or lesser scale; in some places there were even bloody crises. The news of these events, already grave in themselves, reached Rio Grande colored with the exaggeration which time and distance are accustomed to impress upon events. The fear of Portuguese reaction assailed every spirit; the idea of resistance also began to dawn and to become common among all. A perennial distrust was the distinctive feature of the epoch.

The individuals whom the government of Rio de Janeiro sent for the governance of the province differed in nothing, as to political and administrative education, from those whom Lisbon sent with the title of captains-general. First of all, they had the great defect of not knowing the people and the land they were going to direct. Many sons of the province had become highly skilled warriors in the contests with the Spaniards and with the Hispano-Americans; yet the government never placed them in posts of honor. It sent, to command them, old Portuguese generals, inept for war and, besides all this, ignorant of the theater in which they were going to fight and of the special tactics demanded by the wars of the south.

One of these incapable soldiers, foreign to the province, the Marquis of Barbacena, sent to direct the war of 1825, struck upon the Rio-Grandense heart the blow that must

hurt most in a people that supposed itself invincible. Risking without judgment, without method, the battle of Ituzaingó against superior forces commanded by the illustrious Carlos Alvear, he obtained as result the most disastrous defeat that Brazilian arms had ever suffered there. In that battle there were old and seasoned Rio-Grandense officers, who recognized the ineptitude of the adventitious general and attributed their own rout to it alone. The reverse was, for those brave veterans, defenders of the fatherland, an immense pain that wounded not only their patriotism but also their indomitable ancient pride.

There followed the loss of Cisplatina, which, not long before, had been incorporated into Brazil as a province. Although the peoples of the eastern bank of the Uruguay had a sacred right to their independence, nevertheless this victory of the Hispano-Americans, whom an old rivalry separated from the Brazilians, considerably increased the discontent that already existed. One understands how much the arrogance of the victors must have made the vanquished pass through bitter humiliations, still more when these had the conviction that those could justly glory in their triumph, achieved with heroic energy, decided in a pitched battle.

All this accumulation of afflictions and grievances weighed heavily upon the mind of the province. Faith in the paternity of the general government was lost. A rupture was not difficult.

Rio Grande was poor and ruined. It is natural to every people that does not prosper to make the government directly responsible for the misfortunes that pursue it. This occurred in Rio Grande, but with the difference that there the complainants had every reason, even more than they supposed. The central government promoted wars, laid waste the province, sucked away its riches by every means, made use of the services of its valiant sons; only it never took care to dispense to it that protection which becomes necessary to every people at its beginning. Rather it seemed that the entire effort of the center consisted in seeking to dry up the sources of the desolated provincial wealth. The taxes were as exorbitant as they were absurd, preferably burdening those industries whose development ought most to have been stimulated and protected by regular means. Upon dried beef, the *charque*, weighed the extraordinary contribution of six hundred strong réis for each arroba exported, paid at the customhouse of Porto Alegre or that of Rio Grande. The result was that this great industry was rapidly diminishing instead of prospering, while similar products from the Rio da Prata, where only hides of horses and cattle and tallow paid tax, and a very mild one, flowed considerably into the consuming markets.

Cattle hides were subject to the odious tax of the fifth, and this for those exported to national ports; those destined for abroad groaned under a higher contribution. But what made this absurd tax still more absurd was that it had to be paid in the very exported material and not in the corresponding value. Thus, whoever with enormous sacrifices

traversed the countryside buying hides and managed to gather, for example, one thousand, had to deliver two hundred to the treasury, depriving himself of a great part of the advantages that the speculation might provide.

This was still not all: besides these taxes, which extended with equal vexation to all goods, the government ordered, by decree of 16 April 1821, that the tithe also be collected; and to calculate it a table was made so exaggerated that *charque* became subject to another eighty strong réis per arroba; tallow, grease, and yerba mate, per arroba; hides, for each one; and wheat, per alqueire, to another eighty strong réis. This was the principal wealth of the province, its only export at that time, which the government thus crushed beneath the weight of taxes. The fatal result was inevitable: everything languished.

To have an idea of what the people thought of such a plundering system, see what the author of the *Economic-Political Memoirs* says: "We do not know that there is any right to collect tithe from yerba mate, since this product arises from industry and not from cultivation; nevertheless they may found themselves upon some custom, or, to explain ourselves better, abuse. When the priests contended for tithes, they said they were of divine right...; but with all their ambition they demanded no more than the fruits of the earth, and those which did not depend upon industry. Here we are paying tithe on productions of industry, and we do not know what the foundation may be."(1)

Wheat, given the land's excellent suitability for its cultivation, could perhaps have constituted the most important industry of Rio Grande; it was what suffered most from the war of taxation and from the lack of protection by the government, to the point of extinguishing itself completely. The exportation of this article, which in 1813 had been 341,087 alqueires, did not pass in 1820 beyond 109,608, and thenceforth always went on diminishing. Through the lack of renewal of the seed, an indispensable condition for this kind of agriculture, rust began to attack it in 1814. The government was so inept that, possessing every facility, it did not even take care to furnish the cultivators with the new seed they needed, and with which they could not provide themselves in the isolation in which they found themselves, lacking relations with other agricultural peoples, and many of them even lacking exact knowledge of the true cause of the evil. Thus wheat cultivation died; and, interest having been diverted from it, no one ever again took care to revive it.

(1) *Memórias econômico-políticas*, 5th memoir, p. 120.

Never were the evils of centralization, that is, of the absence of liberty, so evident. The central government did not know the needs of the province; and if it knew them, it did not feel them and therefore did not take care to remedy them. On the other hand, local initiative did not exist, could not exist in a system in which all life flowed toward the center; nor did the province, exploited and exhausted, have the means to attend to its pressing necessities. In everything these evils revealed themselves.

The very easy routes of communication, the great and numerous navigable rivers, and the level plains which in every direction offer passage to the traveler, none of this could be fruitfully used: the rivers had no ships, and in the fields there were no bridges to cross the watercourses in flood, except the single bridge of Rio Pardo.

Instruction was sustained exclusively by the private purse. Even in 1820, throughout the whole extent of the territory of the province, there was not a single school of first letters maintained by the state. Only in Porto Alegre had a Latin class been founded. When the government resolved to order public schools created in some parishes, it fixed as the teachers' subsidy the derisory sum of one hundred mil-réis per year. As was to be foreseen, none was founded, because there was no one willing to subject himself to teaching boys while earning 8,300 réis per month. Only the natural fondness of the inhabitants for instruction, still observed today, explains the fact that in that miserable time there were many men tolerably educated. Those who thus enlightened themselves at their own cost, with enormous sacrifices, could not fail to be natural enemies of a stepmotherly government which took so much from the province and gave it nothing in exchange.

Grievances, resentments, hatreds fermented. The conviction was not defined, but it was patent in every mind, that the evil from which the province suffered most painfully was the lack of liberty. Liberty means the power to live sovereignly by oneself in that which concerns oneself alone. The path of federation was opened. The people did

not delay in rushing down it, as tumultuously as the impulse that broke the bonds restraining it had to be violent. And this phenomenon was general throughout all Brazil.

Chapter II

The Moment

The bonds of authority having been relaxed by the forced abdication of Emperor Pedro I, effected by the liberal revolution of 7 April 1831, there began to manifest itself throughout Brazil a phenomenon proper to countries of such vast and varied proportions: the tendency toward disaggregation, which with less noise had already rehearsed itself under the primitive imperial dominion. The victory over the emperor, agitating and shaking the entire country, placed a greater number of spirits more explicitly in the service of this historical law. The forces of revolution received too great a progressive impulse; the forces of conservation, measuring their movement by it, operated driven by an extraordinary retrogressive impulse.

But in the theater of this natural struggle there intervened the powerful action of an antecedent fact: Brazil had separated from Portugal very recently and still gravitated badly balanced, without having entirely annulled the force, which may be called centrifugal, by virtue of which the bonds of union with the old metropolis had been broken. A thin layer of ashes veiled the fire of the ancient hatreds between Portuguese and Brazilians, and the slightest breath sufficed to raise the flame. Nothing fraternizes men so much as community of principles and union in their

defense. Thus it was that the same hostile sentiment which divided Brazilians from Portuguese tightened among the former the relations of civic friendship. Patriotism, love of Brazil, then reigned more fervid than ever. This sentiment restrained, postponed, the fatal eruption of the instincts of fractioning the soil of the fatherland.

The parties which then confronted one another might be called the Brazilian party and the Portuguese party. The liberals of Rio Grande gave to their adversaries the title of *gallegos*, a title which remained in vogue throughout the whole revolution and which, as is known, in popular language designates individuals of Portuguese nationality.

The blow which tore the crown from Pedro I wounded to death the Portuguese party, whose agony thereafter translated itself into the unrealizable longing for the restoration of the expelled emperor. The national element, freed from the greatest tension of the resisting cord, saw the smothered instincts burst forth more strongly. These instincts grew as the anti-national element, impoverished, rapidly marched toward extinction. Already few simulacra of it appeared, and only the Military Society sustained the last breath. Of the old events there existed more the residue of hatreds than the fierce struggle of former days. Such was the situation of the country; such also was that of the province of Rio Grande do Sul, like it delivered over to the free unfolding of its nature, of its special temperament.

Continuously occupied with grave external affairs, defending its own territory from aggressions by neighboring countries, or taking the initiative in hostilities, the

province of Rio Grande had until then always made itself noted by the most pronounced docility toward the central government. It was counted among those which least disturbed it by internal security, rarely troubled by insignificant tumults. There was, however, ancient in the province an undefined feeling of displeasure, of malaise in relation to the course followed by public affairs. As the years passed, this feeling progressed and revealed itself more positively. The struggles and rivalries of the two opposing parties, the effervescence inherent to the time, soon came to accentuate the direction proper to it.

The Rio-Grandense patriots complained that a retrograde faction, spread throughout the country and represented in the province by a large number of partisans, attempted to oppose the liberal reforms which ought to have been the fruit of the revolution of 7 April. The blackest crime attributed to this retrograde faction, however, was that of engaging in conspiracy for the restoration of Pedro I, almost unanimously hated by Brazilians. The most exalted did not even hesitate to discover in it intentions of return to colonial dominion. These suspicions, which could not fail in that time to be exalted to the greatest exaggeration, were nevertheless not completely unfounded. The partisans of the expelled emperor were numerous, especially in Rio de Janeiro. Almost the whole Portuguese colony had adhered to him. The military element, whose first authorities were represented by Portuguese, was as powerful as it was exalted.

Many of the Brazilian officers followed the opinions of their chiefs. The celebrated Military Society founded in Rio had the sole aim of preparing the restoration. This society intended to generalize itself throughout the whole country. Its views at once fell upon Rio Grande, which was the most militarized province.

Surrounded by such distrusts and incited by the general tendency of the country to repel uniformity, forced unity, the Rio-Grandense patriots could not submit without constraint even to the government of the center, although at that moment it was liberal. In Rio Grande, as throughout all Brazil, there appeared the federalist party, advocating the ideas which conservative pressure had smothered in the national assembly preceding the constituent assembly. This party, by a lucid intuition of the conditions and destinies of the country, preached the autonomy of the provinces, united only in political association in common interests, by the federal bond. To defend and propagate this idea, a society had been organized in Rio by the patriots there under the name of the Federal Club, which was to become the center of many others ramified through all the provinces. Thus was revealed the true cause of all the agitations with which the first quarter of our national life was so heavily charged. Nevertheless, this end, which was the capital one, was what the revolutions least succeeded in attaining. Yet there they remain, and, as the most important of all, that of Rio Grande, to attest the perennial solicitation of the country toward the system of federation, which would have saved it from the torpor into which the centralizing compression later cast it.

In Rio Grande, federation was the culminating idea among all liberal aspirations. Nothing, however, authorizes the belief that there were at that time defined republican convictions. Rather, what is certain is that, with the exception of Zambicari and a few others, his disciples, in small number, democracy was repelled by all the liberal patriots.

Tito Lívio de Zambicari was an Italian of illustrious family and bore the title of count. Some affirm that he belonged to the Italian Carbonari. What is certain is that he was a man of vast erudition and talent. An extreme patriot, he had gravely compromised himself in the events that took place in Europe in 1830. Condemned to death, he succeeded in escaping to America, soon coming to settle in Rio Grande. In the first times he occupied himself with studies in the natural sciences, in which he was very versed, devoting himself especially to botany.

The most advanced ideas were discussed and defended in secret societies, with appearances of Freemasonry. That of Porto Alegre, to which the first personages of exalted politics belonged, was called the Continentinos; those of Rio Grande, Pelotas, Rio Pardo, and Jaguarão called themselves Defenders of Liberty and Independence. Zambicari, affiliated from the beginning with the Continentinos and perhaps their founder, was assiduous at all the sessions, where he read memoirs and preached in repeated speeches openly republican ideas. Many times, contradicted by some of his confreres, he sustained with brilliant eloquence long doctrinal polemics. In the journalistic press, where articles of his continually appeared,

it was, with the necessary reserves, the same principles that he preached.

Carried by that almost fanatical sentiment of cosmopolitanism which was so common to the men of that epoch, and which also dominated Garibaldi, Rossetti, Griggs, and so many other foreigners who served the Rio-Grandense Republic, Zambicari made himself loved by all the patriots of Rio Grande and may be considered its true and real mental director. Thus is explained the influence exercised in Rio Grande by the doctrines of Mazzini's Young Italy: they appeared there through Zambicari.

The progress made by the ideas of its adversaries was not unknown to the party called retrograde. They understood the extent of the danger and tried to oppose it with desperate resistance. In 1833 the province was governed by Judge Manoel Antônio Galvão, upon whose sympathy the retrogrades counted. This functionary, at the instigation of his friends, confidentially communicated to the government the imminent danger threatening public order, menaced by ambitious and turbulent politicians, and asked for measures in this sense.

On the same occasion, the commander of arms, Marshal Sebastião Barreto Pereira Pinto, sent an equal denunciation, accusing preferably, as chief of the exalted, Colonel Bento Gonçalves da Silva, superior commander of the entire national guard of the province and also commander of the frontier of Jaguarão. Barreto's accusations concerned above all facts that had occurred on this frontier

of Jaguarão relative to affairs of Uruguay, of which I shall have occasion to treat shortly.

Called to Rio de Janeiro to justify himself against these accusations, Bento Gonçalves went there in May. In the capital of the Empire he found his political co-religionists raised to the height of true directors of the government, still surrounded by the prestige of the victory won by the revolution of 7 April. Instead of pressing upon him the accusations he had suffered, they covered him with considerations, honors, and favors. Bento Gonçalves entered into relations with the most eminent men of the situation: with Evaristo Ferreira da Veiga, who became his friend; with Father Diogo Antônio Feijó, who was already indicated for the high post which he later exercised; and with many others who obtained for him from the government all that he desired. He obtained a promise that the establishment of the Military Society in the province would be prevented, that some of the most inconvenient retrogrades would be removed, and finally, besides many other measures, he secured from the government the commitment to name as president of Rio Grande the law graduate Antônio Rodrigues Fernandes Braga, son of the province and one who inspired the most solid confidence among the liberals, by reason of his honest and moderate character. On leaving Rio, Bento Gonçalves was further rewarded with a pecuniary pension under the title of previous services rendered as a soldier.

Some contemporaries of these events affirm that the idea of revolution settled itself definitively in Bento

Gonçalves's mind during his stay in the capital; that there existed there a plan, conceived by men such as Evaristo da Veiga, to raise the whole country at the same time in order to establish federation, which by legal means already appeared impossible; that in the Federal Club there had secretly been plotted the complete ruin of the retrograde party, as a condition of life for Brazilian nationality. There exists no datum robust enough to discover what truth there is in this tradition; nevertheless, one cannot wholly deny it credit in face of the events that followed, and even of the strange and unexpected manner in which the exalted colonel was treated.

Galvão having been dismissed from the presidency, his substitute was not immediately Fernandes Braga, but José Mariani. It is to be supposed that in this there was agreement with Bento Gonçalves. Mariani took office on 22 October 1833, and already on the following day had occasion to witness the fatal discords of which Porto Alegre had become the arena. The champions of restoration, among whom the commander of arms Barreto was an active but hidden combatant, were making their last efforts for the creation in Porto Alegre of a branch of the Military Society and were already rehearsing themselves for its installation.

The liberals became alarmed. Trusting in the rectitude and impartiality of the new president, who had not yet involved himself in the fervid struggle of the parties, they resolved to appeal to his authority; but, to give more force to the representation they intended, they first

addressed themselves to the municipal council, composed of their adherents, and asked it to represent against the installation of a nucleus of conspirators against public order and tranquillity. The council, as was to be expected, represented immediately, on that same 24th day; but the president's reply, received with general astonishment, not only denied the petition but also reprehended the council for interfering in matters with which it had nothing to do. The people, exasperated and spurred on by their chiefs, resolved to carry out for themselves what the authorities would not do. The exalted patriots armed themselves; their opponents did the same; and for days the city of Porto Alegre, in continual agitation and anxiety, expected at every moment a bloody conflict. The result was that the Military Society was not organized.

In the energetic opposition suffered by the retrogrades, there became prominent, besides many other citizens, Major José Mariano de Mattos, commander of the artillery corps, and Major João Manoel de Lima e Silva, who commanded the 8th battalion of chasseurs, both sons of Rio, and the latter of the notable family which in the capital of the Empire distinguished itself by the adhesion it gave to the retrograde party. He was uncle of Luiz Alves de Lima, who became Duke of Caxias, and brother of the regent, General Francisco de Lima e Silva.

President Mariani understood how powerful the liberal faction was and how imprudent it would be to resist it any longer. He therefore took care to retract his first procedure; and in the speech he addressed to the provincial

council on the day of its opening, 1 December, he declared that the Military Society would no longer be organized, because its members had recognized that it would be prejudicial to public order. But the retrogrades, who persisted in their project and had made no communication in this sense to the president, were as surprised as they were enraged by this procedure. The president was in a difficult position: he did not merit the confidence of the exalted, who had suffered innumerable persecutions from him, such as the suspension of José Mariano from his command; on their side, the retrogrades accused him of disloyalty and weakness.

Lima e Silva, days after the popular movement of 24 October, requested and obtained leave to go to Rio de Janeiro. Brother of one of the regents and friend of various men who had influence in the government, it was easy for him to obtain whatever measures he desired in favor of his friends. He caused orders to be transmitted to the commander of arms to prevent the installation of the Military Society; the president was ordered to make the retrograde Major Gordilho, Viscount of Camamú, withdraw to Santa Catarina, he being one of the most important figures in the popular agitations and in the matrices of the press; and, besides many other measures, he obtained the fulfillment of the promise made to Bento Gonçalves that Fernandes Braga should be named president. With the aim of better guaranteeing order, the government also resolved, in agreement with the interested parties, upon the removal of José Mariano and of Lima e Silva himself, with their

respective corps, the first to Rio Pardo and the second to São Borja.

Braga was named by decree of 14 February 1834 and took office on 2 May. The new president was generally reputed an honest man of good intentions; although moderately, he adhered to liberal ideas; he was a son of the province and recommended by Bento Gonçalves, the most popular man in all of it. His administration was therefore inaugurated surrounded by sympathies and happy hopes. Noisy festivities received him. The exalted believed the retrograde party already wholly extinct, so much so that amid the popular festivities being held, and when on the night of the 2nd the people were gathered in great mass before the presidential palace, among the repeated acclamations that arose, one citizen among the most fervent liberals recited before the multitude and the president these characteristic verses which the enthusiasm of the occasion had inspired in him: O vile Caramurus, inhuman band, Appear now with extinguished authority, And by the whip you shall see your wickedness Punished by a sovereign people.

Vile sectaries of the crimes of a tyrant, Whose brutal wickedness you follow, brutes, O vile heart of foul iniquity, That lives content only beneath the scourge, We shall give you an eternal lash, Restoring and delinquent band! For he who is of hell, let him inhabit hell.

This improvising poet was Antônio Paulo da Fontoura, better known as Paulino Fontoura, who afterward played so conspicuous a role in the republic. His verses give the

measure of the sentiments then nourished by the people regarding President Braga and his administration.

For some time the best relations of cordiality remained between the president and the liberals. But the epoch was exceptional. In these seasons when spirits go laden with blackness and latent storms, delicacies of pride are sharpened, susceptibilities are wounded by the slightest circumstance and make the muffled but not extinguished struggle recrudescence. Braga, by his character, was incapable of provoking a rupture by himself. His principal tendency was to harmonize the enemy parties; and for this, while always treating his liberal co-religionists better, he nevertheless used no pressure against the adversaries. In the state in which things had stopped, this mild procedure, tending toward impartiality, irritated the exalted, who desired the complete extermination of the retrogrades. It was not long before censures appeared in the press against the president for not using the greatest energy against them. Braga became displeased.

His weak and indecisive spirit had permitted Bachelor of Law Pedro Rodrigues Fernandes Chaves, his brother and judge of law in Porto Alegre, to take complete possession of him. Pedro Chaves, who also belonged to the exalted, undertook the defense of his brother against the very friends of the day before. His violent nature soon dragged the discussions of the press onto the terrain of gross and insulting recriminations. The retrogrades hastened to ally themselves with him and with the president. The fatal war was declared anew, and its intensity had to increase pro-

gressively despite every effort to restrain it. Motives were not lacking to embitter rancors and produce the explosion.

The noise of the political press, in the reciprocal attacks of the two parties, assumed truly scandalous proportions. For written injuries directed at Major João Manoel de Lima e Silva, the Viscount of Camamú, already returned to the province, was condemned to prison and withdrew to the barracks of the battalion of national guards. This soldier was accused of having originated there a great mutiny, which very nearly caused considerable bloodshed.

A soldier of that battalion, having disobeyed the commander, Lieutenant Colonel Silvano José Monteiro de Araújo e Paula, received from him a slap and reacted indignantly. Almost the entire battalion rose against the commander. The sectaries or friends of Camamú placed themselves in an attitude of offending Araújo e Paula, who was much esteemed among the exalted. There would have been bloody conflict had it not been for the intervention of the police of the permanent municipals. This was on 1 October 1834.

In the same month there arrived in Porto Alegre the news of the liberal reforms carried out by the constituent assembly in August. Great and thunderous festivities took place on that occasion. On the night of the 24th, a voluminous mass of people, intoning patriotic hymns and raising ardent acclamations, traversed the streets with the justices of the peace at their head. As was natural to the exaltation of spirits, cries of aggression against the provincial government were not rarely mingled with the festive shouts. This was exactly on the first anniversary of the day on

which an equal pronouncement had prevented in Porto Alegre the installation of the Military Society.

The president was in the city of Rio Grande, where he in turn was the object of great popular demonstrations. In the capital, Pedro Chaves imprudently represented his authority. This turbulent young man reacted against the civic festivities, caused the war arsenal, which was a strong house, to be militarily occupied, and, not trusting in the fidelity of the national troops, armed foreign mercenary arms for a great part of the guards. Little was lacking for horrible battles to be joined that night among the citizens of Porto Alegre.

Public animosity was directed preferably against the government's partisans, Viscount of Castro and Brigadier Manoel Carneiro da Fontoura, by whom the people judged itself offended. These two retrogrades were accused of having fired some shots upon the people on the occasion when it was traversing the streets in long procession. Popular exasperation rose so high that a considerable wave of people attacked Brigadier Carneiro da Fontoura and, arresting him, went to present him to the municipal judge Vicente Ferreira Gomes, demanding justice in desperate voices. Gomes was a partisan of the exalted; even so, however, despite his good will, he achieved nothing against the powerful accused.

Meanwhile, the commotion prolonged itself, and each time with a more threatening aspect. All already expected that its outcome would be fatal to public order and security. Braga, advised in Rio Grande, convinced himself

that the only remedy he had to avert the danger was to avail himself of the extraordinary popularity of Bento Gonçalves. He sent in haste to summon him, appealed to his patriotism, and told him that he placed in him such confidence that he would even furnish him with blank letters to do, in the name of the presidency, whatever seemed best to him for the good of order. The colonel acceded, and, furnished with the blank letters, flew to the capital with all possible speed. It was not difficult for him to make a people that adored him take his counsel. Within a few days everything returned to peace and serenity.⁽¹⁾ But spirits were already much shaken, the mass of events too near and too heavy for the catastrophe that had to supervene to be avoided.

President Braga returned to Porto Alegre. From there he wrote to the government of Rio, tracing in loaded colors the tempestuous state of affairs. He denounced the existence of a separatist party. This party, he said, was plotting in combination with influential caudillos of the republics of Uruguay and Argentina and was considering annexing Rio Grande to those republics. He demanded the prompt dispatch of respectable military forces and ended by saying that, if these indispensable resources were denied him, not wishing to be responsible for the evils of his province, he was disposed to request his resignation from an office whose duties he could not properly perform in the occurring circumstances.

The government replied to him that the precarious state of the whole country, where the revolutionary fire was

spreading openly, did not permit the prompt dispatch of the requested forces; that the president should resign himself to manage, in order to guarantee order, with the province's own resources; that, finally, provision would shortly be made to replace him in the presidency, another citizen being sent for that office. This discouraging reply coincided with other new events, which came to make the situation more constricted and difficult.

- (1) This fact, with others, is narrated in Bento Gonçalves's manifesto of 25 September 1835, which I join to this volume as an appendix, judging its reading indispensable to whoever wishes to know well the antecedents of the revolution.

In January 1835, very grave tumults had occurred in the town of Rio Pardo, caused by popular demonstrations against some authorities there, tumults which were common at that time and repeated frequently everywhere, in Viamão, Cachoeira, and principally in Porto Alegre. In the disorders of Rio Pardo, which the adversaries qualified as sedition, individuals of great consideration in the exalted party were involved, among them José Mariano. There was a denunciation and the beginning of proceedings, to which the prudent judge of law Rodrigo Pontes, intent upon seeing spirits calmed, gave no course. Prudence, however, did not suffice to contain the excesses to which partisan fever dragged the men of the two factions. Daily, provocations and ruptures reproduced themselves. The adversaries threatened one another reciprocally with the most unbridled language.

Each side excelled in inventing degrading epithets, contemptuous and insulting appellations to apply to its enemy. The exalted called the retrogrades *gallegos*, *caramurus* (men of fire, that is, of military tyranny), restorers, absolutists, slaves of the Duke of Bragança, hunchbacks, camels, *carimbotos*, and so forth; while those who received these denominations paid them back with others no more flattering, such as *farroupilhas*, rags, anarchists, goat-feet (alluding to the mixed blood of some sons of the country), whence came the celebrated parody of “Brave Brazilian People”: Goat-Brazilian people, Descended from Guinea! They exchanged the five wounds For tobacco and coffee.

And also the stanza “Now you may, sons of the fatherland...” was transformed into indecent verses. One of these allusions was made vividly by some Portuguese and restorers of Rio Pardo, who on Holy Saturday of 1835 displayed several figures of Judas raised on high poles and adorned with horns and goat’s feet. A mulatto slave, who in the morning was vociferating before one of these allusive figures and insulting its authors, was unexpectedly struck down by a musket shot that came from the house opposite. Great commotion spread through the town. Recriminations began, and they came close to open conflict by force of arms. Informed of this state of things, the provincial government senselessly aggravated it, ordering the continuation of the interrupted proceedings of January.

Recognizing the dangers to which they would be exposed by confronting hatreds and passions, none of the justices

of the peace wished to take part in that question, and all excused themselves, declaring themselves suspect, except the daring retrograde Casemiro de Vasconcellos Cirne. Neither requests from friends nor threatening anonymous notices moved him.(1) A numerous group of masked men unexpectedly entered Cirne's house by night and demanded from him the delivery of the records of the proceeding, threatening him with cocked pistols. It is told that on this occasion a daughter of the spirited justice of the peace approached the one who appeared to be the chief of the band and tore off his mask with a courage not to be expected in her sex. At the same time Cirne, who was also armed, fired his pistol against this individual, the bullet tearing away the last phalanx of one finger of his hand. This resistance determined the death of the unfortunate and intrepid retrograde, who fell there on the spot.

(1) Ramiro Barcellos, *Revolution of Rio Grande*, chap. I.

This scene of blood, which everywhere gave rise to rumors and precipitated the revolution, coincided with the opening of the provincial legislative assembly on 20 April, which met for the first time in Rio Grande do Sul, elected by virtue of the constitutional law of 12 August 1834, which, among other reforms, established the provincial parliaments. So strong was the national party that, even despite the powerful influence of the government, it succeeded in having elected its most prominent members, such as Bento Gonçalves, Dr. Marciano Pereira Ribeiro, a distinguished physician, the writer Antônio José Gonçalves Chaves, José de Paiva Magalhães Calvet,

Domingos José de Almeida, besides others. The opponents, in their turn, had brought to the assembly sturdy champions, such as Pedro Chaves, Judge of Law Rodrigo Pontes, and the terrible Manoel Felizardo de Souza e Mello, one of the principal objects of hatred among the exalted patriots.

Incendiary discussions were joined in the provincial assembly, where the two rival forces were almost equivalent, both in quantity and in quality. The president himself, instigated by the impetuous genius of Pedro Chaves, was the one who led the debates onto the improper terrain on which they remained. In his opening address he denounced to the assembly the existence of an occult plan formed by a great number of individuals, with the aim of revolutionizing the province and separating it from the Brazilian communion. His imprudent frankness even went to the extreme of accusing individually, at the request made to him by the assembly, some deputies present as conniving in that sinister plan, or as its organizers.

This was, besides a political error, an injustice: never did the men who made the revolution think, before it, of the separation of the province. They did indeed seek to establish federation throughout the country, which was also an idea common to all the most illustrious Brazilians of those times. This interpretation is what results from an infinity of private and public documents. Even after the empire of circumstances compelled the Rio-Grandenses to proclaim themselves independent, in all official acts of the ephemeral government in which there was reference to

the separation of the province, the same idea of federation appeared more or less explicitly.

The impolitic provocation of President Braga embittered still more, if that were possible, the hostile antagonisms of the two factions. The accused defended themselves, not with energy, but with violence, and redoubled the vigor of their attack. This position obliged the government to seek to entrench itself by every means. To replace the force it had vainly requested from Rio, the assembly voted the creation of a special police corps composed of seven hundred men. The creation of this corps of janissaries, as Bento Gonçalves called it, was voted by surprise, by means of a simple amendment of Manoel Felizardo, when the provincial budget was being approved.

The opposition saw in this a flagrant threat to the security of its co-religionists; and in fact it was. To meet the expenses of this military apparatus, it was necessary to vote absurd and impossible taxes. Among them stood out that of ten mil-réis per square league of land, which exasperated the majority of the province, composed of cattle-breeders. This tax was, in fact, most unjust: it weighed upon capital and not upon product; it fell unequally upon taxpayers, because it did not consider the greater or lesser value of the lands;(1) it was, finally, excessive and cruel, considering the insignificant value of the fields at that epoch and the general poverty of the inhabitants, already burdened with contributions of every kind and constantly plundered in the disorders of the neighboring peoples. The president showed himself culpable and conniving in these

impolitic acts by sanctioning them, when he could have failed to do so, according to article 16 of the Additional Act.

It is easy to calculate the incandescence of the struggle that followed, until the closing of the assembly. Nothing could any longer restrain the revolutionary torrent. Facts relating to the republics of the Plata, in whose evolutions the fate of Rio Grande was always interested, had for a long time been bringing a powerful contingent to the accumulation of elements for the great overflow that would soon begin under a worse character.

General Fructuoso Rivera, one of the most illustrious patriots and first constitutional president of Uruguay, had been elevated to the supreme magistracy. In Buenos Aires the sanguinary dictator Don Juan Manuel de Rosas ruled with discretionary power. It was always Rosas's manifest intent to establish his exclusive dominion over the peoples bathed by the river Plata on one bank and the other, perhaps even dreaming of the unification of the old viceroyalty of Buenos Aires. In this sense he had instigated and favored General Juan Antonio Lavalleja, an ambitious caudillo, to dispute the post with Rivera. Rosas did not yet at that time possess the openly absolute command which he later conquered; but, as a provident man, he was already taking care to prepare matters.

- (1) Manifesto of Bento Gonçalves of 25 September 1835. In the manifesto of 20 August 1838, the then president of the republic speaks further of taxes upon "the hats,

spurs, and stirrups of our horsemen,” which could not have been less odious.

Lavalleja took the field, gathering beneath his standards numerous factious bands. It is a current version that the Brazilian government, inspired by the evil thought of recovering its old possession of Cisplatina, or led by another policy equally perfidious and prejudicial, secretly granted Lavalleja its effective sympathies. It ordered the commander of arms of Rio Grande to give him, with the proper reserves, every possible assistance. This commander promptly passed the proper orders to those of the two frontiers into which such commands were then divided, Rio Grande and Rio Pardo, which were also denominated, the first, Jaguarão, and the second, Alegrete. The first was under Bento Gonçalves; the second was commanded by Colonel Bento Manoel Ribeiro, a brave soldier, native of the province of São Paulo, who for years had served in Rio Grande, winning by his skill and daring great popularity and consideration in the province.

Bento Gonçalves was by many titles, if not a friend of Lavalleja, at least closely attached to him; Bento Manoel, because of earlier events, vowed to Rivera the deep hatred of which that rude warrior was capable, he who was so many times led to the strangest actions by sentiments of this nature. Thus, one through sincere friendship for the protected man, the other through violent animosity against that protected man's rival, the two colonels gladly accepted the orders transmitted by the commander of arms. Those sentiments had not yet, however, been

revealed by acts when the government of Rio, unexpectedly changing policy, revoked the primitive instructions and recommended to the commander of arms that he cause absolute neutrality to be preserved.

Bento Gonçalves and Bento Manoel were shocked by this procedure, they who, besides everything, had already compromised themselves with Lavalleja. Bento Manoel replied to the official letter in which the commander of arms ordered him neutrality in improper terms, which revealed his displeasure and betrayed intentions of disobedience. Bento Gonçalves, in the communications he had with the government of the province, did not tire of treating Fructuoso Rivera as a man dangerous to the interests of Brazil.

Protection for the insurgent caudillo continued, if possible, more frankly on the part of the two colonels and principally of Bento Gonçalves, against whom denunciations, complaints, and claims were continually received from the Uruguayan government by the Brazilian charge d'affaires in Montevideo, Manoel de Almeida Vasconcellos, and by the president and commander of arms of Rio Grande. The fortune of the revolution was not propitious to Lavalleja. When this caudillo, harried by superior forces under the command of Fructuoso Rivera himself, approached the frontier of Jaguarão, Bento Gonçalves received orders to disarm him and intern him in the province. In fact, on the afternoon of 29 September 1832, Lavalleja, followed by his little army and closely pursued by Rivera's forces, crossed the Jaguarão, and, on setting

foot on Brazilian soil, found Bento Gonçalves, who disarmed him and conducted him to his house more as a friend than as a prisoner.

With Lavalleja came a famous personage who, in the preparation of subsequent events, had one of the most interesting parts. This was Father José Antônio Caldas, former deputy to the first constituent assembly of Brazil for Alagoas, of which province he was a son, condemned for taking part in the revolution of 1824 and escaped from the fortress of Santa Cruz in Rio de Janeiro. Having succeeded in fleeing from his prison, Caldas passed into the Argentine Republic, where he served as chaplain of the army. Later, in Uruguay, he was named vicar of Cerro Largo. An extreme liberal, indeed a republican, he at once sought relations with his co-religionists of Rio Grande and became a great friend of Bento Gonçalves and, for that reason, also of Lavalleja. From the moment discord broke out between that caudillo and Rivera, Caldas, rightly suspected as a conspirator, was suspended by Rivera from his ecclesiastical office. To the motives he already had for plotting against Rivera was then added resentment.

In Jaguarão there were long conferences among the three friends reunited. Caldas and Lavalleja maintained the necessity of revolution in Rio Grande; Bento Gonçalves, however, was against it. What is certain is that there perhaps were planted the first germs of the future movement. Lavalleja, in order better to delude Bento Gonçalves's patriotism and win his confidence, before withdrawing to the Rio da Prata affiliated himself with the secret society

which the patriots had in Jaguarão,(1) and, although the Rio-Grandense colonel repelled the idea of any federative bond with Uruguay, the caudillo did not cease to pledge to him all his protection in the event of the rupture he advised.

Lavalleja finally, sending his faithful companion, Colonel Eugênio Garzon, to charter a ship in Porto Alegre, set sail for Buenos Aires, where Rosas was already fondling the idea of goading the revolution of Rio Grande, in order to prevent the influence of Brazil from placing itself across his projects of exclusive dominion in the Plata. Later facts make one believe in such intentions of the sagacious dictator.

Lavalleja in Buenos Aires did no more than prepare himself for repeated invasions of the territory of his fatherland. In 1834 he was again on one of his customary raids when, approaching the frontier of Brazil, he was shattered by Fructuoso Rivera on the bank of the Quaraí, opposite the hill of Jarau, where Bento Manoel's estancia and habitual residence stood. Having taken refuge in Brazilian territory, he was received by Bento Manoel, who despised the formal orders of the commander of arms, and was treated with the best signs of friendship. By Bento Manoel's aid, Lavalleja obtained means to transport himself secretly to Jaguarão, where he conferred with his friend Bento Gonçalves and whence he easily passed to Buenos Aires.

(1) *Apuntes para la historia de la Republica Oriental del Uruguay*, by A. D. de P., vol. 2, chap. 4.

It was about this time that the wife of this general, Anna de Monterroso Lavalleja, a woman of admirable intelligence, incited by the terrible Rosas, who dominated her ambitious spirit and perhaps her heart, undertook a journey to Porto Alegre, where she spread everywhere desolate complaints against the tyranny of Rivera and took every measure toward making him hated by the Rio-Grandenses. It was she who placed the Argentine citizen (Uruguayan, according to others) Manoel Roedas, married and resident in Porto Alegre, in the editorship of *O Recopilador Liberal*, a periodical that became celebrated for the fire with which it defended the exalted party and for the virulence with which it attacked the men of the government. Roedas is with reason suspected of having been an agent and spy of Rosas, provoking animosities and fomenting the revolution.

Marshal Barreto, commander of arms, was increasingly irritated by the conduct of the two frontier commanders, who besides everything were his personal and political enemies. To dismiss them seemed impossible to him, in view of the great popularity of both. Still concerning the last protection they had given Lavalleja, Barreto wrote in a private letter to the Uruguayan minister of foreign affairs: "The two Bentos have behaved very badly; as for the one of the north, I intend to make him enter into order; but the one of the south is indomitable."(1)

In fact, Barreto's punishments fell principally upon Bento Manoel. Against this colonel he ordered military proceedings to be instituted. To Bento Gonçalves he merely

ordered, on 30 December, that he deliver the command temporarily to Captain Sebastião Rodrigues Dias. Persecuted, suspended from the command of his frontier, which was exercised in the interim by his capital enemy José Antônio Martins, lieutenant colonel of the extinct second line, Bento Manoel added this motive to those that already weighed upon his mind and decided formally to adhere to the cause of revolution, of which he was never a favorite, because Bento Manoel was a man without ideas and without cultivation of spirit, a practical and valiant guerrilla fighter, and nothing more.

(1) A. D. de P., *Apuntes*, etc., vol. 2, p. 222.

Braga and Barreto, although still doubtful of the reality of the future revolt and chiefly of the time when it should take place, nevertheless took the precautions and measures which the case required and which were possible to them in the almost total isolation in which public opinion left them. Braga suspended the councilmen of Porto Alegre who adhered to the exalted party. Barreto ordered Lieutenant Colonel José Antônio Martins, a fierce partisan, that as soon as the first attempt at revolt manifested itself, he should call Colonel Bonifácio Issas Calderon to his side and send Lieutenant David Canabarro, a brave warrior whose fame was then discussed with great praise, to seek and arrest Bento Manoel. The commander of arms himself departed for the interior with the intention of better organizing the force and, by his presence, preventing possible tumults.

Knowing of the persecutions being moved against him, Bento Manoel hid himself on the estancia of Lieutenant Hippolyto Francisco de Paula, his friend and justice of the peace in exercise in the district of the town of Alegrete. There he resolved to await the moment when events should call him again to activity.

The provincial assembly closed its labors on 20 June 1835. On the eve of the closing, the 19th, it published, against great opposition from the exalted, a manifesto in which it explained to the province the incident of the denunciation made by Braga against the *farroupilha*, Lavallejista party. This ill-considered manifesto appeared in the government periodical, *Correio Official*, no. 55, of 27 June. The assembly then judged the conspiracy extinguished merely by denouncing it and making public the secret plan. It may be affirmed that in the very bosom of this provincial parliament the idea of revolt was consolidated, not so much by the spontaneous impulse of the party called exalted as by the imprudence, the continual provocation, of those who disposed of force and command. The more the deputies of the opposition became disillusioned, the deeper took root the desperate thought of appealing to violence. They left the daily sessions to direct themselves to the secret clubs, to the unknown conciliabules. There everything was discussed; the plan of attack was traced line by line; the forces on one side and the other were measured; the probabilities and the results of victory were calculated. All saw the evil in the persons of the president and the commander of arms, who were those who gave life to the retrograde band that opposed

the liberal reforms of the revolution of 7 April and principally federation, an idea embodied in all the speeches and in all the doctrinal articles of the press. It was therefore settled that the blow would be directed against these two authorities.

But that blow had to be as efficacious as it was rapid, so that the province should not bleed from the wounds of civil war. For this there was needed an intelligent and prestigious chief who would constitute the focus of irradiation of the forces: all eyes turned to Bento Gonçalves. He was in fact the most salient figure, the most real entity of the whole province. That man of small, of very brief stature, about fifty years of age, intelligent, perspicacious, and experienced, whose fame had come out glorious from all the combats in which, during nearly thirty years of military service, he had fought, had become an invincible power in Rio Grande. Marshal Barreto himself had called him indomitable. The men of power were his enemies, but they feared him to the point of not daring for a long time to remove him from a post of confidence, as was done with others, although he was the most accused. His energy suffered no contrast; the goodness of his heart had created for him infinite and devoted friends; the honesty of his character, full of all virtues, and the sincerity with which he defended the opinions he had embraced assumed the value of a guarantee.

Bento Gonçalves was the chief unanimously chosen. It was he who outlined things, who prepared the antecedents for the harmonious result we are about to witness. All

received his watchword and withdrew to the indicated points. He himself passed to his residence at Camaquã, whence he was gaining and preparing ground. His friends, advised, seconded him throughout the countryside. All, men of great prestige in the places they inhabited, estancia owners, merchants, officers of the line and of the national guard, had in such a manner undermined the terrain of the province that the revolutionary cry, once raised, would easily reverberate through every point.

Chapter III

The Explosion

Such was the general state of things when, on the morning of 19 September, more insistent rumors circulated in Porto Alegre that a formidable sedition was imminent over the city, spreading through the whole province. Impressed by this news, President Braga at once recognized himself powerless for resistance. Barreto still remained in the countryside. There were in Porto Alegre no more than 270 troops, in great part mercenary. This military force was composed of fewer than one hundred soldiers of the permanent corps, some cavalry of the line, the garrisons of two gunboats lying in the port, and the rest consisted of national guards, little disciplined, and paid foreigners. One could not count upon the fidelity of almost all these troops, whom there were serious reasons to suppose won over by the revolutionaries. Marshal Gaspar Francisco Menna Barreto, charged with the defense, was disheartened before the void forming around lawful authority.

The president issued a proclamation, exposing the danger of the situation and summoning the inhabitants of Porto Alegre to the defense of the city, threatened by a band of robbers who desired only to kill and plunder. The exalted tone of the proclamation produced an effect different from what was expected. An enormous fright crossed the hearts of the inhabitants who did not adhere to the movement. The friends upon whom the president counted in great number drew back, hid themselves, fled. Few remained faithful to him.

Among these was no small quantity of Portuguese, regimented by virtue of the imprudent proclamation addressed to them by their vice-consul, who thus stimulated hatreds against the citizens of his nationality and prepared the future outrages of which they would be victims. Different was the conduct of the Hamburg vice-consul, Antônio Gonçalves Pereira Duarte, who recommended neutrality to those under his jurisdiction in the civil struggles that were about to begin; for this Braga became exasperated and at once represented to the government of Rio, asking that the exequatur of the prudent vice-consul be revoked. The government later lightly acceded to this request, while the Portuguese consulate, acting more wisely, dismissed its representative in Porto Alegre. The intervention of foreigners, always solicited by the lawful authorities, was a perpetual motive of just resentment among the liberals.

Still to aid the desperate defense of the capital, Braga sent emissaries to the Germans of the colony of São Leopoldo

and succeeded in engaging some of them. But the fiery activity of the last hour served him nothing. The revolutionaries had maturely prepared the irresistible blow.

In advance, two influential revolutionaries, José Gomes de Vasconcellos Jardim and Onofre Pires da Silveira Canto, had departed unnoticed for the chapel of Viamão and its surrounding areas, to recruit and gather men. Gomes Jardim, who resided in the hamlet of Pedras Brancas, on the right bank of the Guaíba, west of Porto Alegre, was a wealthy estancia owner and one of the oldest and most esteemed Rio-Grandenses in the whole province. Onofre Pires, colonel of legion, famous for his bravery and for the athletic proportions of his body, enjoyed equal popularity. On the morning of the 19th the two chiefs, with a force of more than two hundred cavalymen, camped near the neighborhood of Azenha. They at once put themselves in communication with the friends who were disguised in the city.

The physician Manoel Antônio de Magalhães Calvet, surgeon of the permanent corps, under the pretext of practicing his profession, passed in the afternoon to the camp of the revolutionaries and informed them of what there was in the square. He then returned to the city to note what preparations were being made for the defense, so that his friends might know how they should make their entrance on the following day. Calvet went through the guards and patrols and finally penetrated the presidential palace itself, where the most influential legalists were assembled and deliberating. The matter at hand was to

send the Viscount of Camamú, with respectable forces, to make a reconnaissance in the enemy camp, night already fallen, and, if possible, to surprise it. On returning, Calvet communicated this deliberation to Gomes Jardim, who took the necessary measures, placing his men in readiness and ordering Captain Manoel da Rocha Vieira, known as Corporal Rocha, to post himself in ambush with thirty men to one side of the bridge of Azenha, placing upon the bridge itself a vedette of three soldiers.

Night having closed, Camamú set out at the head of two hundred men,(1) for the greater part armed civilians, toward the determined place. On reaching the bridge, the vedette cried to him, "Who goes there?" to which the major, or one of his men, replied with an obscene phrase, at the same time ordering his force to discharge its musketry, a discharge so disastrously carried out that the vedette remained unhurt at his post. Captain Rocha promptly came up. In the first shock, one of those who were on the bridge, recognizing Camamú, charged upon him violently with lance in rest and, piercing one thigh, threw him down from his horse. Had it not been for the darkness of the night, the viscount would have lost his life, which he succeeded in saving only with difficulty by plunging through some thorn fences of cat's claw that were there. The darkness of night and the uproar raised in the attack by Rocha's men made the assailants suppose that they had to do with enemies superior in number. Panic hastened their flight to the city. One of the assailants, who, having lost his horse in the skirmish, was saving himself on foot, was reached by a caboclo who shouted to

him to surrender. The man on foot replied with a shot at point-blank range, which, fortunately for the other, missed its mark. The shot was paid at the same instant with a vigorous lance thrust that laid the unfortunate man dead. The revolutionary dismounted, untied the lasso from his saddle straps, fastened it to the neck of the corpse, and dragged it to the bridge, where almost all of Rocha's men were again assembled after having slashed the fugitives as far as the gates of the city.

- (1) There is much doubt about the number of these men, even among contemporaries themselves: some say they were thirty, others that they were only seventeen. One witness assured me that they were two hundred.

There they recognized that the dead man had been the legalist Antônio José da Silva Monteiro, editor of *O Periódico dos Pobres*, a retrograde sheet which cultivated the unbridled language in vogue at the time. He was much considered by his co-religionists and even esteemed as a satirical poet of some value, who in his verses did not spare the exalted, who in return had given him the nickname Prosodia, by which he was better known. He was the first victim of the armed revolution. Besides this death there were seven wounded among the legalist forces. The revolutionaries remained unharmed.

The meeting in the president's palace was still lasting when Major Viscount of Camamú arrived there amid great alarm. At the moment he entered the palace, wounded, bathed in blood, having lost his weapons, his horse, and his cap, a sentry by carelessness let a musket shot go

off. The tumult redoubled, the bells rang the alarm, the whole city stirred and was moved. Camamú declared to his friends, astonished to see him in such a state, that he had been attacked by a force of four hundred men, against which no resistance was possible.

The president then took care to have his family and the objects of greatest value belonging to the province, which could be transported, transferred aboard one of the gun-boats. He armed his palace with hand grenades for any eventuality of night attack, and still passed that night on land.

On the following day, 20 September, in the morning, Gomes Jardim and Onofre approached the city at the head of their men. A little before the square of the Gate, the corps of permanents was formed, in an attitude of opposing the entrance of the revolutionaries; but as soon as these drew near, the corps went over to them in mass, raising lively acclamations. So well combined were matters. The president, who, surrounded by his own, was in the war arsenal, where he intended to entrench himself, became wholly discouraged on receiving this news. Precipitately he embarked on the war schooner *Riograndense* and, followed by the *Dezenove de Dezembro*, immediately sailed for Rio Grande. With him he carried many families and some of the few officers who remained faithful to him.

The revolutionary forces entered in the best order, hoisting the national flag, the horsemen adorned with its colors. Everything was disposed with exactness and security. Bento Gonçalves, having departed in advance from

Jaguarão, where everything had been prepared, presented himself in the frontier settlement of Pedras Brancas, accompanied by a small retinue, and entered Porto Alegre under fervent salutations on the morning of the 21st. The active and brave João Manoel de Lima e Silva flew with admirable speed from the frontier of Missions with the 8th battalion, which he commanded, and joined his voice to the cries of victory raised against the conquered authorities. Throughout the whole countryside, the chiefs and influential men of the movement likewise took the positions that suited them. It may be said that from one moment to another the province was in the hands of the revolutionaries.

Having entered the capital, Bento Gonçalves ostentatiously assumed the direction of the movement. He proclaimed the province freed from the odious tyranny that had provoked those events; recommended calm and moderation to the citizens of Porto Alegre; summoned foreigners to the duty of absolute abstention in the struggles engaged; guaranteed the security of persons and property; and wrote officially to the municipal council, almost wholly composed of substitutes, that it should administer the oath to one of the vice-presidents of the province, since the effective president had abandoned his office.

On that same day, the 21st, the council invited the fourth vice-president, Marciano Pereira Ribeiro, and installed him in office. Three citizens preceded the one installed in the order of the vice-presidents: the law graduates

Joaquim Vieira da Cunha, Rodrigo de Souza Silva Pontes, and Américo Cabral de Mello. The council justified itself, however, for having preferred the fourth, alleging that the first three were absent.(1)

- (1) Some have said, and among them Araripe, p. 26, that the true motive was that Marciano Ribeiro, among the other vice-presidents, was the only partisan of the triumphant situation. This is an error. Of the other three, only Rodrigo Pontes was contrary to the revolution. If later there were defections, it is no less certain that on that occasion Vieira da Cunha and Américo Cabral de Mello were liberals.

For the preference given to Marciano Ribeiro there influenced, besides the absence of the others, the consideration that he was a respectable and popular citizen who ought to bring to the revolution a great sum of moral force.

The day of the 20th passed calm and serene, as if the city were not in the hands of revolution. Already in the first following days, however, some ugly scenes occurred, fortunately repressed in time. A Catholic priest, who had made himself notable in the riots of the revolution of 7 April in Rio and for this reason had been exiled to Rio Grande, the notorious Father Pedro, gathered a small mob of turbulent men and went through the streets, giving expression to his ill-understood patriotism, attacking and insulting some members of the defeated party. Armed with a ferule, this furious priest applied to many Portuguese the barbarous punishment of blows upon the hands, afterward obliging the unfortunate victims to give receipt for

what he called payment for the affronts that the national party had received. Hence came the verses which, among others, the troubadours of legality sang: Many revolutions Ancient history recounts to us; But only in this one is prescribed The rod and the ferule.

President Marciano Ribeiro at once ordered this savage abuse restrained. Another disorderly man who sought to stain the revolution was the individual José Ignacio da Silva, known as Juca Ourives. Juca Ourives, who had the trade of horse broker and was generally reputed a man of bad customs, had come as a soldier with the men of Gomes Jardim. On the 22nd he was going about, accompanied by a troop of four or five thieves, asking merchants for cloth and other goods and leaving without making payment. Fear prevented those despoiled from making just reaction. This fact having reached the ears of Gomes Jardim, he immediately ordered Juca Ourives arrested and incarcerated in the military prison.

Besides these and other more insignificant incidents, there occurred in the first days of the revolution one sad event, happily never repeated. Not far from Porto Alegre, in the valley of the Gravataí River, lived the rich estancia owner Vicente Ferrer da Silva Freire, colonel of militia, a respectable old man, honest and head of a large family. Vicente Ferrer, who had not clearly adhered to the revolution, inspired suspicions in its chiefs, who resolved to send for him to come to Porto Alegre with the aim of assuring themselves of the course he intended to take. Captain Rocha was charged with this mission, accompanied by a

small escort, and departed with orders to arrest Vicente Ferrer if by chance he refused to come freely. The escort of Rocha having arrived at the estancia, either because Ferrer did not wish to accompany it or because he made resistance, he was arrested and immediately murdered. Not content even with butchering the poor old man, the barbarous assassins did the same to his younger son Diogo. This act of infamous cowardice, which does not even find excuse in the effervescence of the time, occurred, according to every probability, in Rocha's absence.

On the 25th there appeared a long manifesto by Bento Gonçalves, in which the director of the revolution explained the motives that had precipitated the province into the special situation then witnessed. These motives were in part sketched in the preceding pages. Bento Gonçalves enumerated the undeserved grievances that had been inflicted by the fallen administration upon the military class and principally upon Bento Manoel, "veteran of our warriors," deliberately dismissed from the command of the frontier of Rio Pardo and substituted by a capital enemy.

He affirmed that the whole pronouncement was directed only against the president and the commander of arms, inept and dangerous authorities. Once the revolution was made, which he considered finished, his greatest desire was to go rest in private life, seeing his compatriots happy with the fruits of the liberal system. Concluding, he reminded all of the duty to respect the oath of fidelity to the constitution, to the constitutional throne, and to the integrity of the Empire, preferring the yoke of law to that

of its infractors. Liberty based upon these sacred objects, he said, was a patrimony belonging to future generations, administered by the present one, and which ought to pass intact to those to come.

Scarcely installed, Marciano wrote officially to all the authorities of the province, announcing his accession to the presidential chair and the motives that had determined it. Everywhere his authority was received without contestation, except in the city of Rio Grande and in the towns of São José do Norte and Pelotas. This was due to the presence of Braga in those three contiguous points, he having arrived at Rio Grande on 28 September after passing through Pelotas.

On the 29th Braga proclaimed that the seat of the provincial government had been provisionally moved to Rio Grande. He sent the citizen Manoel Vaz Pinto to Rio, to explain to the central government what was occurring in the province and to demand urgent succors. He then addressed himself to the neighboring commanders and military officers, demanding their aid; but he found obedience only in Major Manoel Marques de Souza and in the national guard João da Silva Tavares, lieutenant colonel. Of the commander of arms he had no news, but it was to be supposed that he was in the countryside, organizing forces capable of opposing invincible reaction to the revolutionaries.

At Braga's arrival in Rio Grande, Provincial Deputy Domingos José de Almeida was there with his family, justly considered one of the most effective and intelligent

impellers of the revolutionary movement. Knowing of his presence, Braga immediately ordered him arrested and confined in one of the warships that were in the port. On the same occasion he took the measure of ordering the publication of the periodical called *Noticiador*, which had always advocated the ideas of the exalted party, suspended. Thus the president sought, by acts of energy, to recover the ground lost in the first surprise, entrenching himself in the city of Rio Grande and thence gradually advancing until he should again establish his shaken authority. He did not know the reach of the power that had overthrown him.

At the same time, Marciano, in Porto Alegre, suspended Marshal Barreto from the command of arms and, by act of 12 October, named Colonel Bento Manoel to replace him. Since, however, Bento Manoel was absent, the office was entrusted in the interim to João Manoel de Lima e Silva; and the interim lasted a long time, because Bento Manoel had to come occupy a seat, as substitute, in the provincial assembly, convened by the vice-president by act of 26 October to meet on 20 November.

Marciano took other measures toward firmly consolidating the revolution. Before everything, it was necessary to dislodge the enemy from the last base of operations that he preserved in the province. Bento Gonçalves and Onofre Pires, each commanding forces superior to one hundred men, were sent, the first to the countryside, afterward to pass to Rio Grande, and the second to São José do Norte. The revolutionaries understood the strategic importance

of those two points, which close the only navigable entrance of the province.

The two expeditionaries had not yet reached their destinations when the legalists Manoel Marques de Souza and Silva Tavares, having gathered in Pelotas a small number of followers, fell unexpectedly upon Captain Manoel Antunes da Porciúncula, brother-in-law of Bento Gonçalves, who at the head of a limited band of revolutionaries was transiting through the surroundings of Arroio Grande. Antunes was defeated in the first shock. The victors published that forty of his men had remained dead on the field, besides eight prisoners. The reports of the vanquished accuse only eleven dead and fifteen prisoners. This skirmish, whose importance was much exaggerated at the epoch, took place on 13 October.

The blind President Braga judged that this encounter decided the fate of the revolution.⁽¹⁾ The reality, however, was that it came to aggravate the situation. The surprise operated by Silva Tavares and Marques had been a true disloyalty and treason. In Pelotas, the judge of law of the district, Joaquim Vieira da Cunha, and the municipal council, seeing inevitable a terrible rupture between these two legalists and Captain Domingos Crescêncio, ardent adherent of the revolution, intervened, succeeding in having a suspension of arms agreed upon until it should be recognized that order could not be reestablished without bloodshed. Trusting in this pact, which had not yet been undone, Manoel Antunes was careless at Arroio Grande

when he was surprised and defeated. With every reason the revolutionaries were irritated.

(1) Araripe, p. 26.

Not trusting in the efficacy of the results of this unconfessable victory, the two legalist commanders, recognizing how little security they had in places infested by the enemy, made by various roads for the city of Rio Grande, where they would join President Braga. They knew moreover that Bento Gonçalves, who at that time was directing himself toward the frontier, being advised of the event, was returning by forced marches with the aim of taking revenge. Marques succeeded well in the retreat, but Silva Tavares did not have equal fortune. Colonel Antônio de Sousa Netto, who had gathered in the municipality of Pelotas a corps of more than four hundred cavalrymen, was wandering through those heights. On the 16th,(1) a party of Netto's, of which the Uruguayan Raphael Berdum formed part, assaulted Silva Tavares at the Retiro crossing on the Arroio Pelotas. Completely routed, Silva Tavares was obliged to seek salvation in flight and, with eight of his men, to take the road to Uruguay.

Meanwhile, Bento Gonçalves and Onofre were approaching the legalist domains. On the 21st, Onofre, already with three hundred men, presented himself before São José do Norte and besieged that town, which later received from the Empire the decoration of heroic for the tenacity with which on several occasions it repelled the arms of the revolution and of the republic. Bento Gonçalves, on the same day, summoned the frontier city of Rio Grande

to surrender. Fernandes Braga, powerless for defense, immediately transported himself aboard one of the war vessels anchored in the port. With him he took many public employees, legalist families, official papers, besides seventy contos de réis in money belonging to the public treasury of the province and what he had already brought from Porto Alegre. The city having been abandoned, Bento Gonçalves entered it without encountering obstacle on that same day, 21 October. The government of the revolution was immediately recognized by the municipal councils of Rio Grande, São José do Norte, and Pelotas. Fernandes Braga remained for some time yet with the flotilla of the province near the point of the bar, perhaps hoping that the reaction of his few and dispersed friends would permit him to return to land. Losing heart, however, he left the bar on the 23rd and sought the port of Rio with his retinue. Thus did this president leave the province, a good and honest character, but incapable of governing, who by his ineptitude aggravated hatreds and precipitated the fatal outcome.

- (1) Araripe, p. 228, makes this event occur on the 22nd and gives it as won by the legalists, who had only one dead, while the revolutionaries had nineteen. I guide myself by some manuscript notes that belonged to Manoel Martins da Silveira Lemos, brother of Father Chagas, who was inspector of the treasury of the Republic. Martins wrote at the time the events were occurring. Besides, since it is certain that Silva Tavares, because of a defeat, fled to Uruguay, where he arrived days after Barreto, who entered there on 12

October (*Apuntes*, chap. 6), it seems he could not have been victorious in this action, which was the only one he engaged in October after that of Arroio Grande.

While these events occurred in the circumscription where the revolutionary seat properly stood, others no less interesting followed one another in the countryside, attesting the spontaneity of this movement, which had long been latent in the heart of the province.

An ardent and brave young man, though inexperienced in the vicissitudes of war, Colonel Affonso José de Almeida Corte Real, witness of the triumph begun on 20 September, quickly sent word to Bento Manoel of what was happening, reminding him that it was time to fulfill his promises by joining his co-religionists for the liberation of the province. The colonel moved from his asylum on the estancia of Lieutenant Hippolyto de Paula. Always fearful of the consequences of so risky a step, undecided between the sentiments of spite and vengeance that labored in his heart and the little sympathy he felt for the triumphant liberal ideas, he sought to veil his conduct with appearances of legality and to leave open a door through which he could escape in case of reverse, avoiding the tremendous responsibility he incurred.

With this aim he addressed himself to the municipal council of the town of Alegrete, insinuating to it the necessity that it take part in the events in order to prevent the disasters being prepared. The council at once replied in an official letter, supplicating him to place himself at the head of a respectable force to avoid the effusion of Rio-

Grandense blood. All the councilmen signed this message, with the president, Joaquim dos Santos Prado Lima, a citizen who still lives today.

Furnished with such a document, which greatly attenuated his responsibility, Bento Manoel, commanding more than two hundred gaúchos, gathered for the most part by Lieutenant Colonel Cláudio José de Abreu, took the road to São Gabriel, which was already at that time the military center of the province. At the Rosário crossing, on the Santa Maria River, he proclaimed, explaining his pacifying mission, a mission with which he had been charged at the instance of the municipal council of Alegrete.

From there, following the river, he came to ford it at the São Simão crossing, near the confluence of the Cacequi; and, ascending the left bank of this last stream, he came to camp at the estancia of Severino Antônio da Silveira, a notable local influence for the revolutionary party. Through this estancia owner Bento Manoel learned that the valiant guerrilla fighter, Captain João Antônio da Silveira, brother of the same, attached to Corte Real, had surrounded and obliged to surrender in São Gabriel some companies of the 3rd regiment which had fortified themselves there in the house of Manoel Gomes de Carvalho. This regiment was commanded by Captain Francisco de Paula Macedo Rangel, who later died a general. There were dead and wounded. The revolutionaries thus took possession of the regiment's barracks, commanded by that captain. Bento Manoel then crossed the Cacequi and marched rapidly upon São Gabriel, where he presented himself the follow-

ing day. There he considerably swelled his small troop. He ordered the imprisoned officers set at liberty. The soldiers adhered to the revolution. Besides this contingent, Colonel Olivério José Ortiz joined him with one hundred and thirty men, and Captain José Rodrigues Vaqueiro with the company he commanded.

Marshal Barreto, who for some time had remained in Bagé, was at this occasion staying in the heights of the Jaguari. Advised of the danger that threatened the 3rd regiment, he at once set out with the 2nd, which was detached in Bagé under the command of a Major Ângelo, with the aim of giving succor to Paula Rangel. But the revolutionary spirit had contaminated the entire province: after a day's march, the regiment refused to accompany the commander of legal arms. Between the Jaguari and the Vacacaí, near the Batovi crossing, on 4 October, Lieutenant of the 2nd Manoel Luiz Osorio placed himself at the head of the risen men and obliged Barreto to retreat with the few officers who wished to accompany him, fleeing to hide himself in the territory of Uruguay, where he entered on the 12th of the same month. Osorio took the road with the regiment to São Gabriel. There he presented himself to Bento Manoel and adhered to the revolution.

In Rio Pardo the partisans of the fallen situation offered serious resistance to the revolution. A force of one hundred and fifty men entrenched itself there, composed of forty troopers of cavalry of the line, eighteen of artillery, twenty-six of infantry, thirty Germans, and some armed civilians and slaves. They possessed besides four pieces

of artillery, which they placed in convenient spots: two at the point called Estreito, one on the bank of the Jacuí, and another on the bridge that gives entrance to the settlement. These people were captained by José Joaquim de Andrade Neves, by the justice of the peace Manoel Alves de Oliveira, by Captain José Ferreira de Azevedo, by Lieutenant João da Silva Barbosa, and by other individuals who had figured actively in the persecutions at the beginning of the year of which the liberals there complained so much. By resisting, they hoped to escape the reprisals of which they would be victims in the hands of their enemies.

They were surrounded on the side of the town by Lieutenant Colonel Francisco de Paula de Moraes Sarmento Menna with two hundred men, Sebastião Xavier do Amaral with fifty, and Antônio Vicente da Fontoura, major commander of the national guard of Cachoeira, with some two hundred.

On the opposite bank was the justice of the peace Cândido de Azambuja, with a good number of men. Sarmento Menna desired to carry out the arrest of all those compromised, so that proceedings might be instituted against them.⁽¹⁾ These, fearing vengeance, were disposed to resist at all costs. A great carnage was imminent. Bento Gonçalves sent, on 25 September, an emissary to the scene of the conflict, who was to reduce the besieged to surrender by persuasive means, complete liberty being guaranteed to them. This emissary achieved nothing. But finally, through the efforts of Fontoura and of Bento Gonçalves himself, who recognized that the favorable position of

the besieged allowed them to sell dearly their defeat and imprisonment, they came to an agreement, surrendering on condition that they should freely depart wherever they wished. Only on 9 October was this capitulation effected, which avoided a great shedding of blood.

- (1) Sarmento Menna had drawn up the following: “Relation of the public employees and other individuals who, as heads and collaborators in the persecutions of Rio Pardo, must be arrested, directed to the public prisons, and prosecuted according to the laws, namely: the ex-municipal judge José Joaquim de Andrade Neves; the justice of the peace Manoel Alves de Oliveira; the ex-justice of the peace Paulo Nunes da Silva Jardim; Captain José Ferreira de Azevedo; the councilman Francisco Gomes da Silva Guimarães; the councilman Manoel José Machado; the councilman José Francisco da Silva, Canamba; the collector Manoel Lobo Ferreira Barreto; Victor José de Figueiredo Alves; Sergeant of the 1st corps José Antônio de Moraes; the lawyer Agostinho José de Menezes; Lieutenant of the 2nd corps João Machado da Silveira; Constantino José de Vargas; and especially Lieutenant João da Silva Barbosa. Encampment on the eastern bank of the Cahy crossing, 28 September 1835.”

There was no longer throughout the whole extent of the province a single question to be solved. The victory of the revolution was complete and absolute.

Bento Manoel found himself strong after the events of São Gabriel, surrounded by respectable forces, at the same time that he saw the horizons clear of enemies. In these circumstances it seemed to him that the best course to take was to divide his men, who made up a robust column of more than eight hundred men. He would thus avoid the warlike apparatus while at the same time keeping himself fit for future events. He left João Antônio in the municipality of São Gabriel, made Corte Real march to Porto Alegre, Olivério Ortiz to Caçapava, whence he had come, and followed with the greater part of the column to the banks of the Ibicuí, until he should receive more secure news of the fate of Silva Tavares and Barreto. He finally marched to Alegrete, whence he made Lieutenant Colonel Manoel dos Santos Loureiro return to his post of Missions with the corps of three hundred men he commanded and which had come to Alegrete to receive orders.

Apparently, the revolution was finished with the skirmishes that had occurred. Bento Manoel had not drawn his sword. Now he was preparing to go to Porto Alegre, invited by the vice-president to take a seat, as substitute, in the provincial assembly convened extraordinarily for 20 November. That session, it was said, had as its aim to heal the wounds opened by the revolution. So much was this revolution considered finished.

Bento Gonçalves, after the definitive expulsion of President Braga, also announced the revolution extinct. On 25 October he sent two envoys to Montevideo, José Carlos Pinto and Captain Manoel Joaquim de Oliveira, who

carried letters for the Brazilian charge d'affaires, Manoel de Almeida Vasconcellos, and for General Manoel Oribe, president of the republic, who that year had replaced Fructuoso Rivera. In these letters Bento Gonçalves declared the pacification of the province complete and the revolutionary aspirations satisfied, which had been summed up in the expulsion of the president and of the commander of arms. He asked Oribe not to consent that the emigrants Silva Tavares and Barreto, whom he supposed protected by Colonel Servando Gomes and Rivera, should make gatherings in the republic to disturb anew the peace of Rio Grande. He begged Vasconcellos to exert himself also in this sense and protested his fidelity to the national government. From Rio Grande Bento Gonçalves went peacefully to Jaguarão, acclaimed everywhere as liberator of the province.

Vice-President Marciano Pereira Ribeiro addressed himself to the government of Rio, protesting obedience to it, asking the appointment of an effective delegate to replace him, explaining the causes that had moved the province to revolution, and guaranteeing in his name and in the names of the chiefs of the movement that all would cooperate so that order should not again be disturbed. He added a formal denunciation against the ex-president, for whose crimes he asked punishment. The assembly, as soon as it installed itself, addressed an equal representation.

Peace was complete. The procedure of the central government was anxiously awaited, and all, moreover, counted it favorable to the revolution. Meanwhile, spirits, held in

suspense, prepared themselves for resistance in case the most compromised should not be positively guaranteed and the liberal victory sanctioned, which constituted the principal effort.

Chapter IV

Bento Manoel

When Braga arrived in Rio de Janeiro on 29 October, he already found the country governed by Father Diogo Antônio Feijó, who, by virtue of the constitutional reform of 12 August 1834, replaced the triple regency. Braga went frightened, disappointed, and breathing rancor. He painted matters to the regent in dreadful colors. Feijó, ignorant of the serenity that then reigned in the province, of which Braga himself was not well informed, instead of sanctioning the revolution, which besides everything was already consummated, took care of the means to repel and suffocate it. Only he could not do so ostensibly, with great apparatus, because he had few resources at his disposal. The whole country was rudely shaken, violently disturbed. The attention of the regent was simultaneously attracted to infinite and diverse points.

Father Feijó was a sincere patriot; but sincerity is an immense evil when unaccompanied by certain conditions. The man sincerely convinced of error becomes a scourge. In this case was Feijó: ultra-liberal on the abstract terrain of propaganda, a politician of sentimentalism and not of reasoning, he developed in practice, raised to the supreme post of the nation, a supreme incapacity, alongside savage

instincts of tyranny. It was he who precipitated into perdition the great principles of 7 April. To him also is due the blood shed in Rio Grande do Sul, and what is still more lamentable than the blood, the rendering useless of the saving ideas which Rio-Grandense patriotism had to concretize and plant in the bosom of the Brazilian nation. Had Feijó not been weak for aggression, he would from the outset have ordered the Rio-Grandenses shot, as he intended to do with his old co-religionists, the patriots of the Campo de Sant'Anna, and as he did with those of Ilha das Cobras, deserving men who have not yet found, as Estêvão Marcello did, a historian to avenge their memory.

Feijó did not reply to the representation of Vice-President Marciano Pereira Ribeiro, just as later he despised that of the provincial assembly, which a commission of the Chamber called a seditious conventicle. He considered Braga dismissed. He named to replace him the law graduate José de Araújo Ribeiro, who was also a son of Rio Grande and general deputy for the same province. Araújo Ribeiro was a grave man, studious, cultivator of the physical and natural sciences, a firm character, but of a firmness which in politics led him to authoritarianism.

The new president departed in the brig-bark *7 de Setembro*, and on 6 November entered the bar of Rio Grande. He brought no military forces; neither were there any in Rio, nor was armed ostentation convenient. His ship came, however, loaded with military stores,(1) which, in case of need, he would distribute among the adherents of the government and among the numerous friends he

had in the province and whom he would seek to attract to his cause. The regent had given him a proclamation in which he invited the Rio-Grandenses to concord.⁽²⁾ This proclamation was afterward reinforced by another dated 4 December, in which the regent obliged himself to obtain from the general assembly amnesty for the rebels who returned to legality. Feijó did not understand the character of the revolution. He judged that to satisfy and extinguish it, it was enough to cry to the revolutionaries: "Return to due obedience to the legitimate authorities, and, far from giving credit to those who terrify you with the idea of punishment and persecutions, trust in the paternal views of the regent in the name of the emperor." If the pretext of the revolution was a secondary fact, such as the expulsion of two superior authorities, Feijó ought not to have ignored that its real cause was another and very different.

- (1) Bento Gonçalves, Manifesto of 29 August 1838. (2) In a letter published in the journal *A Discussão*, year II, no. 19, Mr. José Pinheiro de Ulhoa Cintra, an old republican, says that "when Araújo Ribeiro was named president of this province, he came furnished with a decree of general amnesty and never published it." This decree, which certainly depended upon an indemnity law, I judge to be distinct from the proclamation of 4 December.

In the city of Rio Grande, Araújo Ribeiro delayed a month. Knowing that Bento Gonçalves was in Pelotas, he personally went there to confer with him. He urged him to lend aid for pacification. Bento Gonçalves replied

that he judged the province to be at peace, and that he only expected, with his companions, that the conduct of the government would be just and reasonable. He also did not fail to observe to him that his excessive delay in Rio Grande, where he conferred assiduously with individuals hostile to the revolution, was already provoking suspicions; that for this reason he was of the opinion that he should go without delay to present himself to the provincial assembly, in order to take office. The president promised to go and asked Bento Gonçalves to transport himself also to the capital, calming along the road and in that city the spirits of his co-religionists. Bento Gonçalves did in fact depart on the 21st, and so confident was he in the good intentions of Araújo Ribeiro that, writing to a brother, he said: "I was with the new president, José de Araújo Ribeiro: he seemed to me a very good person and I believe he will be a very good government." (1)

Araújo Ribeiro arrived at Porto Alegre on 5 December. He already found Bento Gonçalves there. There also arrived at the same time the order of the government of Rio, in answer to Braga's representation, commanding that the vice-consul of Hamburg, Pereira Duarte, be prosecuted for the proclamation which on 20 September he had addressed to the Hamburgers, advising them neutrality. The revolutionaries were alarmed. The government showed itself decided to persecute them, since it spared not even the vice-consul, who without opposing it had not, meanwhile, unduly protected it.

(1) Ramiro Barcellos, chap. III.

Bento Gonçalves gathered his friends several times. He made them see that, although from his previous conversations with Araújo Ribeiro he had not discovered hostile intentions in him, nevertheless he, as representative of the general government, whose thought was already revealing itself, could not be favorable to them. He proposed, therefore, that the president's taking of office be hindered until he should exhibit secure guarantees of respecting the September revolution and its men. Feijó's proclamation promising amnesty, drawn up on 4 December, had not, and could not have, yet reached the province. Suspicions grew. Araújo Ribeiro dealt assiduously with Bento Manoel, his friend and relative according to some. He sought the other chiefs little.

Bento Manoel's fidelity had always been inwardly doubted by those who knew him closely. It was known that this colonel had been involved in the events by special facts, by sentiments of vengeance against Sebastião Barreto. Neither the heart nor the intelligence held him any longer, for by intelligence Bento Manoel was never guided. Araújo Ribeiro sent to the assembly the decree naming him president, accompanied by an official letter in which he asked that they appoint for him day and hour for the oath and installation. The assembly, on 8 December, met in secret session. The question was discussed, the same doubts being raised that already wandered in the public mind. It was proposed that the president's installation be postponed. The whole assembly, composed of few full deputies and many substitutes,(1) was partisan of the revolution. Nevertheless, one voice rose against

this deliberation: that of Bento Manoel. The colonel scarcely knew how to express himself; nevertheless he spoke with heat. He said that to deny the possession claimed by Araújo Ribeiro was to renew the war; that he, a Paulista, did not wish to contribute to the effusion of Rio-Grandense blood; he declaimed upon the sincerity of the intentions of the president and of Father Feijó's government; he said that, in any case, he would submit to the deliberation of the majority; that he was one of the revolutionaries and was disposed to accompany his friends in good and ill fortune; but that if he had to take up arms again for the revolution, it would pain him to have to go drag from their hiding places those who knew how to inflame spirits but did not know how to fight. That same night Bento Manoel conferred secretly with Araújo Ribeiro, and later facts make one believe that he definitively promised him his support, abandoning the friends of the day before.

- (1) The provincial deputies were then: Francisco Xavier Ferreira (president), Canon Thomé Luiz de Souza (vice-president), Antônio Álvares Pereira Coruja (secretary), Domingos José de Almeida, Pedro José de Almeida (Pedro Boticário, editor of *A Idade de Pau*), Father Juliano de Faria Lobato, José Mariano de Mattos (major), Silvano José Monteiro de Araújo e Paula (lieutenant colonel, editor of *O Echo Portoalegrense*), Serafim dos Anjos França, Vicente Ferreira Gomes, José de Paiva Magalhães Calvet, Bento Manoel Ribeiro, Bento Gonçalves da Silva, José Pinheiro de Ulhoa Cintra, Dr. Américo Cabral de Mello,

Vicente José da Silva França, Father Francisco das Chagas Martins Ávila e Souza, Father Fidencio José Ortiz, Olivério José Ortiz (colonel), Gabriel Martins Bastos.

On the following day, the 9th, in public session, the assembly received a representation from the justices of the peace of Porto Alegre and Pedras Brancas, asking in the name of the people that the possession be delayed. It then immediately voted for refusal, giving as its motive that it attended to the representation of the justices of the peace and of the people and was going to address itself to the general government so that the latter should decide conveniently.

Colonel Bento Manoel, however, showed himself quite in accord with the opinion of his colleagues. He merely took care to convince everyone that his presence in the countryside was urgent. The assembly had addressed to the people of the province a proclamation in which it explained the motives of its procedure; Bento Manoel said that he wished to go aid the effect of this proclamation; without him, spirits would continue exalted. All more or less persuaded themselves of his sincerity. Then Bento Manoel resumed the command of arms, exercised in the interim by Lima e Silva. He conferred again with Araújo Ribeiro and departed for the countryside, always announcing to everyone that he was going to quiet spirits and, in case of necessity, combat the counterrevolution. It was not, however, the proclamation of the assembly that

he carried; it was those signed by Araújo Ribeiro. Bento Manoel had gone over.

Araújo Ribeiro behaved no less craftily toward the revolutionary chiefs. He departed again for Rio Grande, telling everyone that he was simply going to await there the solution which the government of Rio should give to the assembly's representation asking guarantees. He went, however, to plot better, in partnership with Bento Manoel, the ruin of the revolutionaries. There he received Feijó's proclamation of 4 December. He wrote officially in this sense to the assembly, which resolved to send a commission of two deputies and Major Lima e Silva to examine the regent's promises. This commission, which departed Porto Alegre on the 23rd,⁽¹⁾ seeing that Feijó treated the revolutionaries as criminals for whom the most that could be expected was clemency and pardon, that he made only a doubtful promise of amnesty, and that he did not commit himself to sustaining the liberal principles of the revolution, returned without accommodating itself with the president.

(1) *O Povo*, political, literary, and ministerial journal of the Rio-Grandense Republic, no. 111.

The return of this commission to Porto Alegre coincided with the sad news arriving from the countryside that confirmed Bento Manoel's defection. This colonel, leaving the capital, had directed himself to São Gabriel by the road of Santa Maria da Boca do Monte, gathering some men in these two municipalities and in that of Caçapava. In São Gabriel he took command of the small forces he found. On

30 December he proclaimed, in his quality as commander of arms, sustaining Araújo Ribeiro and ordering the troops to render obedience to him as legitimate president. In the proclamation Bento Manoel said that he so acted because the municipal councils of Rio Grande and São José do Norte had requested it of him, being engaged in saving the province from the claws of a separatist and republican party that had come to dominate the provincial assembly itself. The request of the councils to which he referred had in fact been sent to him by Araújo Ribeiro, who was already plotting the reaction while deceiving the revolutionaries. The bearer of these representations had been the law graduate Sebastião Ribeiro, son of Bento Manoel and sent by him with the aim of adjusting the plan with the president.

Bento Gonçalves had already sensed in time the inward thoughts of the other Bento. Seeking to avert the sad outcome, he wrote him a letter in which he reminded him of the duty incumbent upon the chiefs of the revolution not to deliver their friends into the hands of the government without the latter offering secure guarantees. Bento Manoel replied with evasions. His conduct did not cause great surprise, although it kindled just indignation in the hearts of his former friends. Hatred against Barreto had been deadened by time, attenuated by the satiety of vengeance; his persecution against a fugitive and unfortunate enemy no longer had reason to exist. Araújo Ribeiro had known how to conquer his friendship. An uncultivated spirit full of restless activity, Bento Manoel might have much astuteness, but very frail notions of the sentiments

of honor and dignity. Easily, therefore, could he transfer himself from his party to the adversary's. Personal resentments were always, in truth, the springs of his actions.

From the moment Araújo Ribeiro resolved to tame the revolution by force, he took care to prepare himself conveniently for the fatal war he understood he must kindle. What is undeniable is that he developed a special tact for everything he planned. In Rio Grande he accumulated elements of resistance, while Bento Manoel charged himself with gathering in the countryside the elements of attack. Captain Procopio Gomes de Mello, gathering some five hundred men among the three maritime settlements, came to garrison the city. On the other hand, Bento Manoel, though with difficulty, gained ground, gathering some men in the countryside. The emigrants returned to the province. The president felt himself fit to begin the enterprise openly and, in his turn, declared the war open, taking possession of the presidency before the municipal council of Rio Grande on 15 January.

Araújo Ribeiro communicated this illegal act to the assembly. The latter answered him at once on the 27th, inviting him to come before it to ratify the oath, without which it could not recognize him. The president refused to do so. Then the assembly proclaimed to the province that it should not render obedience to an authority that was scandalously rebelling against the imposition of the law. It addressed itself further to Vice-President Marciano Pereira Ribeiro, ordering him to continue in the administration, and on 11 February addressed yet another

representation to the general government, exposing the reasons for the crisis and once more asking punishment for Fernandes Braga, promoter of all these occurrences.

In the month of February the war was kindled. On the 14th Marciano Ribeiro dismissed Bento Manoel from the command of arms and named Major Lima e Silva to exercise it. On that same day, the 14th, Araújo Ribeiro, in Rio Grande, issued the dismissal of Bento Gonçalves and Netto from the commands they exercised in the national guard.

Warlike activity arose on both sides with equal zeal. Lima e Silva left the city and on 2 March surprised a group of legalists that was incorporating itself at Capané, making among them some arrests and deaths. He then marched upon Pelotas with his habitual speed. More serious events, however, were preparing themselves.

Bento Manoel strove to gather in the countryside the greatest possible number of combatants; but so universal was the revolutionary sentiment in the whole province that around this notable chief there gathered only a corps of approximately two hundred men, with which, in slow marches, he took the road to the capital, in order to disturb there the seat of the revolutionary government. Meanwhile, from Porto Alegre Colonel Corte Real had departed in search of him, commanding a column of nearly eight hundred men, composed for the most part of citizens ardent with enthusiasm, but more accustomed to the life of the capital and the etiquette of salons than to the raw hardships of war. These enthusiastic volunteers

could not be measured against the experienced guerrillas of Bento Manoel.

Nevertheless, at the place called Irapua, Bento Manoel was on the point of being irretrievably lost, enveloped and suffocated by numbers. Corte Real directed against him a pursuit without quarter and already considered him secure when the legalist chief appealed to one of those stratagems that made him so celebrated in this struggle: he sent to meet Corte Real his inseparable companion, as brave as he, Captain Demetrio Ribeiro, as emissary of peace. Demetrio said on behalf of his commander that, not wishing to be the first to cause Rio-Grandense blood to run, he was disposed to disband his troop on the following day and withdraw outside the province, of which he was not a son. For this he asked only time to camp in peace, and on the following morning he would fulfill the promise.

Corte Real was young and little acquainted with the enemy with whom he was dealing. He easily and with great pleasure acceded. He halted immediately, camped, and took no measure to watch Bento Manoel's conduct. This one simulated stopping as well; but as soon as he noted the pursuing column camped and careless, he set out in rapid and precipitate march, walking all that afternoon and the entire night in such a manner that the following dawn Corte Real found neither trace of his supposed encampment, nor even of the direction taken by his fugitive steps. Needled by this bitter experience, Corte Real advanced in slow marches until he crossed the Santa Maria River at the

Rosário crossing. He camped on the left bank, disposed to await events there, or learn exact news of the enemy's movements.

Free from pursuit, Bento Manoel communicated with the legalist commanders Antônio de Medeiros Costa and Silva Tavares, who had just returned to the province. He designated for them the Dom Pedrito crossing for the junction of the three forces. The junction was carried out according to Bento Manoel's plans, and the government column, raised to seven hundred men more or less, marched along the left bank of the Santa Maria, seeking the enemy camp. At the estancia of Santo Antônio it formed in closed column and advanced in the best order upon that of Corte Real. The latter had already sensed the enemy at a league's distance. With calm and time he chose terrain, disposed his men for attack, and addressed them a speech, guaranteeing the certainty of victory. Silva Tavares asked Bento Manoel to take the vanguard because, as the one more compromised before the revolutionaries, he ought to be the first to open combat. Bento Manoel agreed. Corte Real was also at the front of his men.

The combatants of one and the other faction, almost equal in number, advanced with equal firmness; but the patriotic enthusiasm of the revolutionaries had to yield to its own inexperience. Their lines broke at the first charges of the seasoned legalists. The dispute did not last more than half an hour. Few remained dead on the field. The prisoners rose to two hundred. Among them was counted Corte

Real. No other fruit could be gathered by men who knew as little how to govern the horses they mounted as how to handle arms.

Such was the notable combat of Rosário, realized on 17 March, which, stimulating the fainting spirits of the legalists, struck the revolutionary party deeply. The sweeping impetuosity of the valiant young Corte Real did not permit him to wait, by means of skillful evolutions, entertaining and deceiving the enemy, for the aid that Bento Gonçalves was bringing him at the head of six hundred men of the best cavalry. Corte Real did not heed the repeated official letters in which Bento Gonçalves warned him of his approach, and when the latter was already three days' march away, he engaged the fatal combat. He did not wish to share the laurels of victory with his friend and chief, and defeat was the appanage of proud inexperience. Had it not been for this great error, the Empire would then have lost its only force capable of confronting the revolution.

Some successive victories, meanwhile, at that time raised again the revolutionary arms. Lima e Silva arrived at Pelotas. There, with eighty infantrymen, Major Manoel Marques de Souza was detached. Surprised by Lima e Silva on 7 April, Marques entrenched himself in a two-story house of the settlement and was there surrounded. By this procedure he sought to give time for a force of one hundred and twenty men, commanded by Colonel of militia Albano de Oliveira Bueno, to come to his aid. Albano de Oliveira was camped at the Passo dos Negros, in the environs of the settlement. Energetically threatened

by Lima e Silva, however, Marques had to surrender. The revolutionary commander did not leave Albano time to be informed of what was happening. He moved at once rapidly to the Passo dos Negros and presented himself before him on the morning of the 8th with much superior forces, but disposed matters in such a way that Albano could not fail to accept combat. The defeat was instantaneous and complete: nearly twenty of the legalists remained on the field; the rest, including the chief, was imprisoned.

Having consummated such important deeds, the revolutionary commander of arms retreated toward Porto Alegre, threatened at that time by Brigadier Gaspar Menna Barreto and by other legalists. At the same time he ordered Domingos Crescêncio with three squadrons to patrol the city of Rio Grande. On setting out, he gave liberty to the prisoners who wished to adhere to the revolution and kept imprisoned those who offered him no guarantees of fidelity. As for Colonel Albano de Oliveira Bueno, he ordered him shot before the troop.

This act, which the enemies attributed to repugnant perversity, practiced by a man as virtuous as João Manoel de Lima e Silva, young, enlightened, brave, and generous, could not fail to have been inspired by some powerful reason that excused it. In fact, that reason existed. Albano did not reside in Brazil; he was an estancia owner in Uruguay. He was a mercenary adventurer who had come to the province with one hundred and twenty foreigners paid at two patacões per day, with the money of the very people

whose blood he came to spill. Ex-President Braga and Silva Tavares had engaged him for this infamous mission. (1) He was a robber, a great criminal, who justly received the summary justice of the revolution. The entire province was on the side of the so-called rebels; the government always saw itself obliged to make use of foreigners to fight it. Why did Lima e Silva not also order Major Marques shot, more fearsome, moreover, than the mercenary Albano? Simply because, as he himself declared, Marques was a soldier who fought freely for his opinions; he was not hired, bought for the carnage of citizens. The author of this narrative has not the least interest in hiding the truth about particular facts of the great drama he describes, because he is certain that any partial blemish would be illuminated and undone by the harmony of the whole, and even because the discredit of the cause of 1835 would not be that of the cause of today. The interest that exists is to tell the historical truth, drunk in good faith from the best sources.

- (1) Under letter B of the appendix is the proof of these assertions, besides what is current tradition in the province.

Lima e Silva marched upon Porto Alegre with such speed that he presented himself there on the night of the 12th. At his arrival the city was alarmed: the legalist Juca Ourives, with nearly three hundred followers, was charging upon it at that very moment, and would easily have taken it had it not been for the accident that made Lima e Silva come out to meet him, repel him while aiding the inhabitants,

and oblige him to take, fleeing, the road to the settlement of Mostardas, where a new reverse awaited him.

This Juca Ourives is the same soldier of Gomes Jardim arrested in Porto Alegre in the first days of the revolution for going about plundering the business houses. Onofre Pires, having at that time to march to São José do Norte, obtained his release so that he might follow in the expeditionary force. Onofre camping at Passo da Areia, near the capital, the soldier Juca Ourives, among other disturbances and crimes, committed there a barbarous assault against an honest family home, violating a young woman of the place. He was then again arrested by order of Onofre; but this time he succeeded in escaping from prison and, going to present himself to the legalist forces, we now have him raised as military chief. He was a resourceful and active gaúcho, a great horseman, and although of the worst customs, had a reputation for courage. Perhaps thus is explained the rapid ascent he had in the ranks of legality. On the night of his assault upon Porto Alegre he was repelled, but did not suffer great pursuit, because there was no cavalry in the place and that of Lima e Silva came excessively tired by the great marches.

Nor did he have great loss: in Olaria Street only two of his soldiers remained dead, and one near the war arsenal. There was a greater number wounded.

Lima e Silva still surprised and dispersed a nucleus of legalists that was forming in the Faxinal, reinforced his men with some Germans who wished to enlist, and on 20 May departed Porto Alegre, uniting to the command of

arms that of the division destined to dislodge President Araújo Ribeiro from Rio Grande.

Onofre was already again besieging São José do Norte, defended principally by the sea forces, of which the revolutionaries were almost absolutely lacking. The navy was all composed of foreigners, such as Pascoe Grenfell, Parker, and others, and of sons of other provinces. It was always hostile to the revolution, which had on its side almost only the sons of the province, although nearly unanimously. Its triumph would be infallible if it disposed of sea forces as it disposed of land forces.

Taking the road to Mostardas, Juca Ourives joined with the legalist Captain Francisco Pinto Bandeira, who was wandering with some men through the north of the province and from Torres was directing himself to São José do Norte, with the aim of aiding the defense of the town against Onofre. The united forces of the two chiefs rose to a total of more than four hundred men, with whom Juca Ourives marched resolutely in the direction of the town, counting the defeat of the enemy as certain. Onofre, however, advised in time by his partisans, went out to meet him with three hundred and fifty men, to which number his people amounted. Near Mostardas, already close to the legalists, he chose terrain appropriate for combat, on the flank of a hill, ordering his men so that more than half remained hidden from the enemy's view. When Juca Ourives saw him from afar and recognized that he had to fight so reduced a force, he advanced disorderly and with the natural impetus of one who suddenly

has the question resolved. At the same instant, the skillful Onofre, making his men circle the hill several times, squadron after squadron, made it seem to the attackers that they had before them an interminable army, and the primitive enthusiasm was transformed into terrible indecision. But the charge had already been made from a long distance, and, although disheartened and sparse, their ranks came up to those of Onofre, who made them wheel at the point of shock, coil themselves beneath an active carnage, and retreat in complete rout. The conflict lasted some time. In the midst of the melee there stood out above all the combatants the colossal figure of Onofre, commanding and cutting at the same time. It was more a slaughter than a combat. Surrender saved the vanquished from total extermination. Many remained prisoners, while Juca Ourives fled with a limited band. Thirty were killed by edged weapons, and among them Pinto Bandeira. Of the revolutionaries there were only four dead. Field pieces, munitions, and other objects of war belonging to the legalists, all fell into the hands of the victor. The news concerning loss of men and equipment is furnished by documents of legalist origin. This important combat occurred on 22 April. A notable trait of the character of those times is that among the prisoners were two colonels of the line, Antônio and Jacynto Pinto de Araújo Correia. These two soldiers of such high rank in the army were commanded by the civilian Juca Ourives.

Chapter V

Reverses

The good star of the revolution was about to decline and grow pale, clouded by a series of hard and consecutive reverses, with which this second phase of its life approached its term.

It is known that the vice-president and the provincial assembly continually addressed themselves to the government of Rio, protesting obedience to it and asking the substitution of the interim authorities by effective ones, which, sanctioning the September revolution, would lead the province back to the normal state. The general government never gave them answer; and finally, by act of 3 March, it took from them all hope of conciliation, ordering that the public offices of Porto Alegre be transferred to Rio Grande. The government thus approved the procedure, so censured by the revolutionaries, of Araújo Ribeiro in taking illegal possession of the presidency before a municipal council while the provincial assembly was functioning.

This act of the government, which seriously harmed the revolutionaries, who until then had presented themselves only as sustainers of legality, was followed by a military reverse, in truth of little importance compared with those that were to supervene, but which had the worst remote consequences, depriving the revolution of one of its most active and best champions. Having arrived at Pelotas from his expedition to Porto Alegre, Lima e Silva did not for some time succeed in engaging action with the enemy,

who troubled him more by water than by land. Finally, on 2 June, he caught by surprise in the São Gonçalo River two gunboats and a small war steamer. To attack them was great temerity; but Lima e Silva did not retreat before the danger, seduced by the possible but most difficult victory. He advanced to the river bank with six hundred men. A very lively fire was at once engaged. After some hours of combat, the three ships succeeded in getting into the open, escaping the boarding which those on land were already preparing to give them.

According to the reports of the legalists, no more than four of theirs died, whereas of the revolutionaries ninety succumbed. Lima e Silva received in the face, on the left cheek, a wound from grapeshot, whose projectile weighed more than an ounce,⁽¹⁾ and fell prostrate. Such a wound forever disabled this brave man, who nevertheless did not die of it, perhaps because he was destined to a more obscure and sad death at assassin hands. Despite everything, his activity did not fade, although his forces continually diminished; even wounded and broken, he continued to disturb the government and the people of Araújo Ribeiro, and only on 12 August did he enter Pelotas again, where he was solidly organizing his column for a formal attack upon the city of Rio Grande. The annihilating blows that the revolution successively suffered, however, did not permit the realization of his plan.

The principal of these blows, the one that led all the others, was the restoration of Porto Alegre on 15 June. In that

city Major Marques had been imprisoned since 12 April, having been arrested and conducted there by Lima e Silva.

(1) *O Povo*, no. 111.

The revolutionaries did not take care to place this prisoner in due security, at the request of Lima e Silva, who had compromised himself for him, affirming that Marques had pledged himself not to take up arms against the revolution, captive, as he said he was, of the delicate treatment he had received from his captor. Meanwhile, even from prison Marques conspired. He succeeded in recruiting the guards who watched other prisoners and himself; through one of these guards he established communication with Gaspar Menna Barreto, and, escaping and raising the prisoners and some soldiers, restored the city to legal dominion.

Porto Alegre was almost abandoned. Marques had no difficulty in taking all positions. Vice-President Marciano, who, having on 16 February passed the administration to his colleague Américo Cabral, had exercised it again since 28 March, was arrested and imprisoned. Many provincial deputies and public functionaries and other citizens partisan to the revolution had the same fate. Care was soon taken to install this multitude of prisoners aboard an old ship anchored in the center of the Bay of Guaíba, a ship which received the popular name of *Presiganga*. The legalists were always more cautious than the revolutionaries; therefore also, once the city was conquered, they never again lost it. Araújo Ribeiro was informed without delay of this great event and hurried to the old capital as soon as possible.

The news of the unexpected and sudden restoration of Porto Alegre painfully impressed all the revolutionaries and particularly Bento Gonçalves, who at once received notice from the provincial deputy Ulhoa Cintra, who managed to flee in a boat in broad day, taking refuge on the neighboring island of Pintada, despite the lively fire which the legalists from the war arsenal directed against him. Bento Gonçalves, while the events referred to were unfolding, was working in the countryside with great activity, running through the province at every point, animating his friends and combining with them, pursuing enemies, in short impelling the revolution by every means. On 21 January he wrote officially to Antônio Vicente da Fontoura, ordering him to keep himself with his men gathered for whatever might happen. Bento Gonçalves sent this official letter from the road to São Leopoldo, where he had already dispersed the people, for the greater part enlisted Germans, whom Gaspar Menna Barreto, João de Castro, Silva Barbosa, and others were regimenting there. These legalists had attempted to cross the Rio dos Sinos at the place of that then colony with two hundred German infantrymen, three hundred cavalrymen, and fifty Brazilians, including the officers; but they were prevented by fifty patriots posted on the side of the colony, aided by some colonists directed by a certain Lalles, or Salles, a German. This Lalles, or Salles, enthusiast of liberal ideas, passed to Gaspar's camp and, after having with him a heated dispute, harangued his countrymen in the German language, unknown to that general, and persuaded them to abandon the legalist ranks, which all

promptly did. Many crossed the river and incorporated themselves with the revolutionaries; others withdrew to their labors. On that same day Bento Gonçalves arrived, and Gaspar Menna Barreto and his companions fled at his presence, dispersing.

There reinforcing his column, Bento Gonçalves departed by Sant'Anna do Rio dos Sinos toward the districts watered by the Jacuí. From Arroio dos Ratos he issued on 7 and 8 February two proclamations to the national guards and other citizens of the municipality of Cachoeira, inviting them to take up arms. He again ordered Major Fontoura, Colonel José Manoel de Leão, and Francisco Sarmiento Menna to hasten the gatherings and cover the movement which he would begin on the 10th, directing himself to Pelotas and making junction with Colonel Netto and Captain Domingos Crescêncio de Carvalho, who were already in the field.

But the position of Bento Manoel, who, abandoning São Gabriel, afterward escaped the pursuit of Corte Real while seeking junction with Silva Tavares and Medeiros, drew Bento Gonçalves's eyes to these legalists, who in their turn were now threatening the force of the deceived Corte Real. Arriving at São Gabriel, the colonel found the news of the defeat of Rosário. He then marched with the greatest speed upon Bento Manoel; but the latter, skillfully withdrawing through the Serra de Caverá, by trackless roads impracticable for the tired column of the adversary, obliged him to countermarch, delaying himself about the heights of the Santa Maria River and of São Gabriel, with

the aim of drawing Bento Manoel into the open field. Until the end of March Bento Gonçalves was engaged in this effort, without achieving anything. At last he retreated to Arroio dos Ratos, where on 13 April he received the news of the assault that Juca Ourives had made upon the capital the previous day. Thinking that this caudillo had taken the road to São Leopoldo, a place of continual agitations, the colonel immediately lifted camp and directed himself to the Rio dos Sinos, with the intention of pursuing and capturing him.

For this precipitate march he disposed everything with great tact and security: he wrote officially to Fontoura that the latter should cover his movements, avoiding the possible danger of surprise by the enemies who remained in the rear, joining in case of necessity with the force of the district of Santo Amaro, commanded by Captain Antônio Joaquim de Souza; Fontoura should entrench himself at the royal crossing of the Taquari if the enemy crossed the Rio Pardo, giving notice at once for the colonel to return to his aid; the forces of São José de Camaquã and Encruzilhada would occupy the mouth of Arroio dos Ratos, directed by Captain João Borges Pereira and Ensign Manoel da Silveira; all the horses of the environs would be placed out of the enemy's reach, bringing them into the terrain occupied by the revolutionaries; these horses, which would remount the column on its return, would be entrusted to the guard of an active officer at the estancia of a certain Bibiano, on the right bank of Arroio dos Ratos. The revolutionary chief was obliged to these precautions by the existence of Bento Manoel in the interior of the

province, dominating even part of the frontier. For some time Bento Manoel, thanks to this good disposition of the revolutionaries, could not cross the line occupied by them. Only after Bento Gonçalves had returned from the expedition to São Leopoldo was the legalist colonel able, not without some danger, to open a road to Porto Alegre. On 1 June the advance guards of his column met at Arroio dos Ratos with those of Bento Gonçalves, and a small combat was joined, which remained undecided, few men dying on one side and the other. This was at the crossing of the stream, which Bento Manoel crossed with sagacious skill, giving no time to the enemy to come with sufficient forces to prevent him. According to Bento Manoel's official report, four revolutionaries and one legalist died; according to Bento Gonçalves's, six legalists were killed and among his own there were only some wounded.

In these operations Bento Gonçalves was occupied when he was startled by the news of the restoration of Porto Alegre. The distance at which he found himself from the capital was not small. Only on 27 June did he present himself before it, summoning the garrison to surrender, when the restoration had taken place on the 15th.

The garrison of the city amounted to nearly eight hundred men, including civilians who lent themselves to the defense. It was commanded by Brigadier Gaspar Menna Barreto and by Major Marques. Bento Gonçalves's force was much inferior in number and almost wholly composed of cavalry, an arm useless for the kind of combat being prepared. To wait for junction with other forces,

which would double the number, was to give the besieged time to improve the regular defense of trenches that already existed. Bento Gonçalves did not hesitate to risk as soon as possible an assault upon the trenches, such was the importance of the disputed point. The legalist garrison disdained his summons of the 27th. Bento Gonçalves then disposed his men before the places of easiest access, which were the two extremities of the city by the water, Riacho to the south and Caminho Novo to the north. On the 30th the attack began simultaneously by land and from the Bay of Guaíba, whence some launches and the war schooner *Farroupilha*, which had long served the revolutionaries, fired. The action did not prolong itself much. Bento Gonçalves at once understood the immense superiority of the garrison and ordered withdrawal. Fourteen soldiers remained dead to him, while the legalists suffered almost nothing.

The victors could not, however, boast of having Porto Alegre wholly subject to their dominion from the beginning: by land and by water the city remained incommunicable. Bento Gonçalves, withdrawing to Viamão, kept all land exits blocked, without the legalists being able to dispose of more than the peninsula on which the city stands. At the mouth of the Guaíba in the Lagoa dos Patos, at the place called Itapuã, Simeão Barreto, a Portuguese ardently devoted to the cause of the revolutionaries, commanded the garrison of a small fortress that prevented fluvial communication. The cares of the legalists converged upon this last and most inconvenient position, and Colonel

Francisco Xavier da Cunha, adoptive Brazilian, soon took charge of attacking it.

The fort of Itapuã was defended by some pieces of artillery. Before it stood the little fort of Junco, built upon a point of the islet of this name. The two padraços, although they had the advantage of being able to direct plunging and convergent fires upon ships that passed, were weak to resist a regular aggression. That of Itapuã, which was the better, could be attacked by land. Thus Cunha gave more attention to the assault than to the bombardment. On 26 August he landed at Itapuã three hundred and twenty troops of the line, brought by a flotilla under the command of Captain-Lieutenant Guilherme Parker, who had been charged with this by Vice-Admiral João Pascoe Grenfell. The assaulting forces charged at the same time by land and by water. The combat was deadly and fierce, but relatively rapid. Some thirty legalists remained dead, and there was a much greater number of wounded. The garrison, ten times smaller than the assailants, perished almost entirely. Simeão, fighting desperately, ended by drowning in the river. The victors completely razed the fragile bulwarks that had opposed them with such furious resistance. Thus ended the last dominion that the revolution exercised upon the waters. Already in July the schooner *Farroupilha* had been taken by surprise by the legalist Ventura Maia.

At this epoch affairs suffered a slight stagnation: the revolutionaries were brought low by the hard reverses that had successively crushed them; the legalists were settling questions relating to the presidency of the province. The

general government, finding that pacification was being delayed for lack of firmness in military operations, understood that it should entrust the presidency of the province to a general. It therefore dismissed Araújo Ribeiro and named to replace him Marshal Antônio Elisiário de Miranda Brito. The city of Rio Grande received the new delegate unwillingly. Through the municipal council it asked him to delay taking office until the government reconsidered its act, in view of a representation being sent to it, conducted by Vice-President Vieira da Cunha. Nevertheless, Elisiário took office on 14 July. Dissension broke out among the legalists, who divided themselves into two groups: that of the Ribeiristas and that of the partisans of the new president. But this fact did not have the consequences it might have produced, because the general government, accepting the representation of the people, reinstated Araújo Ribeiro, who took office on the 24th. The crisis therefore lasted no more than twenty days. It was on this occasion that Araújo Ribeiro transferred himself definitively to Porto Alegre.

Chapter VI

The Republic

Lima e Silva, who remained in Pelotas ill and devoted to the care of reorganizing his column, which was called the right, while that of Bento Gonçalves was the left, had been able to do nothing of importance. After the attack against the gunboats on 2 June, he spent the time preparing to attack Rio Grande, as he had already done after the

victories of 7 and 8 April, sending Crescêncio with three squadrons. His forces had only two occasions to meet the legalist forces: in the first, on 13 June, Calderon and Silva Tavares were pursued under lively fire from the Lagoa de Caimbá to the fort of São Miguel, but, having arrived there, defended themselves with advantage; in the second, on 11 July, a part of the government squadron having attacked the small fort placed at the bar of the São Gonçalo, it was repelled with some losses.

Meanwhile, although Lima e Silva undertook few actions, his position seriously impressed the legalists. With the aim of expelling him, Silva Tavares was charged to depart for the countryside, swelling his force with recruits and junctions with other commanders. He had already gathered five hundred and sixty men when, taking the road to Pelotas, he camped in the fields called Seival, some thirty leagues from the point he sought. The revolutionaries knew his plans in advance and took care to go out to meet him. On 10 September Colonel Netto reached him, commanding only four hundred and thirty men. The imbalance of forces did not stop Netto. He charged by surprise upon the legalists and radically routed them, killing one hundred and eighty, wounding sixty, making one hundred and sixty prisoners, and suffering insignificant loss among his own. These results, as rapid as they were marvelous, were common during the whole war; nevertheless this is one of those cases in which the spirit feels impulses to refuse reality. Silva Tavares had the greatest difficulty in fleeing, followed by a few men, remnants of his destroyed column. This legalist was brave, bold, and tenacious; in

all this struggle, however, there was no one more unfortunate than he. He never directed a combat in which he was not defeated. Once, only to the generosity of the victor did he owe the preservation of his life. Already the enemies called him “warehouse of the rags,” by reason of the certainty they had that at each encounter with him they would replenish themselves with uniforms and provisions, so abundant were the spoils that Silva Tavares always left behind. Nothing, however, moved him from his effort, and the courage with which, escaped from one reverse, he at once went to provoke another is a title to sympathy for him.

Other partial but brilliant triumphs covered the revolutionary arms in those days. The legalists, leaving Porto Alegre on 7 September, attempted to oblige Bento Gonçalves to evacuate Viamão, but were repulsed with some losses. It was for deeds practiced in this encounter that the legalist José Joaquim de Andrade Neves, the same who later occupied so brilliant a post, merited promotion to ensign of the national guard.

By one of those operations so natural to the habits of the gaúcho, a small party of revolutionaries annihilated an entire brigade that was preparing to enter into operations in the countryside, under the command of Colonels José dos Santos Loureiro and José Maria de Almeida Gama Lobo Coelho d’Eça. The victorious party was directed by João Antônio and Lieutenants David Canabarro and Jacinto Guedes da Luz, whose bravery was never exceeded

and who were among the many future military chiefs who never allowed themselves to be defeated.

On 7 September Canabarro encountered at the headwaters of the Ibicuí the legalist Captain Albernaz and routed him, apprehending, besides some men, all the baggage. From the papers carried by Albernaz, Canabarro learned that another legalist, Major Terencio, was going through Uruguay buying horses for the government and that shortly he was to cross the Quarai with the horse herd, intending to join at the place called Cerca de Pedra his co-religionist Major Lopes, who was camped there with the principal part of the brigade, that is, with three hundred men. Guedes set out with forty companions to bar Terencio's passage.

He in fact found him on the 10th and, shattering and easily dispersing the people who followed him, took possession of the horses, eight hundred in number. As soon as Guedes returned with this rich prize, the three resolved to attempt a reckless attack upon Lopes's own camp and followed there.

João Antônio understood that, for his one hundred and forty-five men to gain any advantage against the three hundred enemies, it was necessary to carry out a well-directed and reliable surprise attack. To this effect he resolved to establish, on the afternoon of the 11th, a skirmishing party that would distract the legalists, so that, as soon as night closed, some of his men could penetrate their camp with the aim of learning the exact point they occupied. The skirmish began, sustained by Canabarro

and Guedes with sixty-five men, João Antônio placing himself with eighty in a hidden hollow at some distance. Before night fell, the guerrillas were already little by little transforming the skirmish into true combat, when Guedes, exalted by the ardor of the fight and enraged by the provocations and insults that came from the legalists, came to an understanding with Canabarro, and the sixty-five charged upon the three hundred.

The unexpectedness of this charge stunned the legalists, who, far from supposing such daring in so few men, were careless and in disorder. Though it seems incredible, the defeat was instantaneous. When João Antônio arrived on the field, night already closed, he found it deserted: the legalists had fled, and the sixty-five revolutionaries, pursuing them, had sown the field with enemy corpses. Only the following day was the small force of the hundred reunited, and it still captured some fugitives hidden in the nearby woods.

Jacinto Guedes received several wounds: an enemy lance would have pierced him had it not found the doubled collar of the poncho he wore tied at the waist; a bullet grazed his nose; a strong blow on the back, given with a bolas stone, obliged him to spit blood for some time afterward. The others, in general, came out unharmed. The people defeated on those three days, 7, 10, and 15 September, intended to unite themselves with that of Silva Tavares, who on that same day, the 10th, was tasting a similar disaster at Seival.⁽¹⁾

- (1) In the notes of Manoel Martins da Silveira Lemos, to which I have already alluded, the following is found: "September, 7, 10, and 15: at Faxinal, Cerca de Pedra, and the bank of the Ibirapuita, sixty-five free men completely defeated more than three hundred imperials, commanded by Colonel Gama and Juca Loureiro." This information is not exactly in accord with what I have narrated; but I believe I am not in error, not only because I find it more rational that the thing occurred in the manner described, but also because I have in this sense the authority of a contemporary witness, Lieutenant Colonel Manoel Lourenço do Nascimento, who thus set forth the same facts in the Pelotas journal *A Discussão*, year I, no. 122.

These events, occurring in the same month and almost without intervals, encouraged and raised again the revolutionary spirit, beaten down by the previous misfortunes. New hopes of triumph were reborn in all. Netto commanded a column of nearly four hundred men, of the best cavalry, still intoxicated by the splendid victory of Seival; Bento Gonçalves had in Viamão more than six hundred disposed to follow him everywhere; Lima e Silva was stationed in Pelotas with seven hundred, and the luster of his name made his seasoned men terrible; the other chiefs, such as Fontoura and João Antônio, gathered followers and were disposed, with characteristic firmness, to dispute to the end the ground won by the revolution.

Only one hope had vanished in the hearts of all: that of reconciliation with the lawful government. Continuous

reinforcements of men and military stores were arriving from Rio de Janeiro, where partisan hatred more than love of country depicted the revolutionaries as thirsty beasts. The government tempered its acts by these most partial reports. Almost all the population of the province belonged to the revolution; those who fought it were for the most part sons of other provinces, of Portugal, or of other countries. The fiber of Rio-Grandense patriotism revolted.

To surrender arms, sterilizing the September revolution, subjecting themselves to the long violences of an infallible reaction, even if veiled by amnesty, delivering themselves to the discretion of foreigners, repelled the patriot chiefs. On the other hand, a convenient reconciliation was impossible between two parties, each of which supposed itself victorious. But what above all became insupportable was the continuation of the present state of things, which presented the prospect of an indefinite war, or of a certain defeat.

These were the sentiments that labored in the minds of the revolutionaries. All perceived at once and at the same time that there was only one road that presented an exit from so many embarrassments: the separation of the province from the Brazilian fold, with whose government any harmony had become incompatible. And thus the crisis was solved.

Netto was camped on 12 September upon the left bank of the Jaguarão River, the extreme of Brazilian territory. On the afternoon of that day he stood before his comrades

in arms and addressed them. He said that the province had already been revolutionized for a year; that the aim of the revolution was to free it from an odious retrograde faction, principally composed of foreign individuals, but that the government, ordering the revolutionary chiefs persecuted, took from them all hope of achieving that aspiration; that there were only two roads to follow in the present circumstances: submission, with prejudice to liberty, or the separation of the province, with the victory of principles, although with enormous sacrifices; that this latter was the only one compatible with honor and patriotism; that, for his part, he was disposed to sacrifice everything for this sentiment; that Rio Grande, separating itself from Brazil, would form a free and independent state under the republican form, but would preserve its old love for its Brazilian brothers and would at any time accept the confederation of all the other provinces that placed themselves in the same political conditions; that the great majority of Rio-Grandenses, being for the revolution, only hostile to foreigners, was also necessarily for independence, a cause sympathetic to all peoples and principally to the neighboring republics, which would not fail to aid it; that consequently he invited his brothers in arms to raise the cry of Rio-Grandense independence and liberty.

And he raised cheers to the Rio-Grandense Republic, to its defenders, to religion, and to Bento Gonçalves. The whole column answered with fervent shouts. It was thus that, on the afternoon of 12 September, on the left bank of the Jaguarão, the Rio-Grandense Republic was proclaimed.

This thought had already insensibly penetrated the whole revolutionary party. There was not one single adherent of that party who protested against Colonel Netto's cry. Netto is accused of arrogating to himself the arbitration of the will of the whole population. But there can be no more banal accusation. Every initiative must start from some point. Nor was his cry a burst of militarism or rule by caudillos. Netto and those who surrounded him were armed citizens; they were not soldiers. Netto was not an adventurer, but a respectable citizen, orderly and calm, rich and independent. Accuse him of error: that is another question, which may be discussed and resolved. But it is necessary that once and for all petty malicious insinuations, which tarnish history's sovereign majesty, be swept from the terrain of history. The men of the revolution did not begin the notable September movement as republicans. If in that character they had begun it, securely taking the necessary positions at the moment when, the lawful authorities having been expelled, they had the entire province closed in their hands, perhaps the Empire, incapable of defending itself and still more incapable of attacking, undermined by the tremendous crisis it was passing through, would have found itself obliged to renounce the restoration of Rio Grande. The revolutionaries, however, wanted only the autonomy of the province, without the principle of the integrity of the great nation being broken. Meanwhile the incompatibility between the dominant regime and this great aspiration was evidenced from the outset. Independence and democracy came fa-

tally, as the only solution of liberal ideas well understood. They imposed themselves upon the will of men.

Such has always been the history of liberal revolutions: either they succumb beneath reactionary pressure, or logic drags them to legitimate democracy. Often the very men who serve them do not understand them; they take from them the social character, the broad character, to attribute to them egoistic and narrow features. But men are instruments of ideas: they work for them without knowing for what they work, without apprehending the ensemble of facts toward which they are directed; for revolutions are like the mountains of which the poet Hugo speaks: only from afar can they be seen from base to summit.

It is told that before the proclamation of the republic, Netto had sent as emissary his brother José to General Manoel Oribe, who since 1 March 1835 replaced General Rivera in the presidency of Uruguay, whose mandate had expired on 24 October 1834. Oribe always had sympathy for the revolutionaries, and, after becoming rival to Rivera, his old protector, revealed them more openly. Netto sent to claim from him the aid he had so often promised. Then Oribe replied that, being in friendly relations with the government of Brazil, it was not convenient for him to animate the revolution of one of that nation's provinces, and that the only means he saw of fulfilling his promises was for Rio Grande to raise an independent flag. If this tradition is true, such an occurrence must certainly have contributed to precipitating the outcome.

Netto at once communicated what was happening to the municipal council of the town of Jaguarão, with which it is to be supposed that he was already concerted in this sense. He asked it to take the position that patriotism indicated. The council waited for 20 September, anniversary of the revolution, to meet. Present that day were the councilmen Domingos Moreira, president, José Fernandes Passos, João Antônio de Oliveira Valle, Manoel Gonçalves Meirelles, and Severino Antônio de Medeiros. They unanimously adhered to the proclamation of the republic and resolved to post edicts throughout the municipality, declaring this resolution, which they considered that of the majority of the people. Since a government was necessary that should from the beginning direct the helm of the nascent state, they named for this effect Colonel Bento Gonçalves da Silva, with the title of chief and protector of the Rio-Grandense Republic and liberty, under the condition, however, of convoking with the greatest possible haste a constituent assembly, in whose bosom he would deposit the discretionary powers attributed to him. The council sent Bento Gonçalves an official letter accompanied by a copy of the minutes of the session. This official letter was remitted through the intermediary of Lima e Silva, who was still in Pelotas. Because of the reverse of Fanfa it never reached the hands of the colonel, and was delivered by Lima e Silva to the council of Piratini on 6 November. Today the author of this narrative possesses it.

Chapter VII

Fanfa

Bento Gonçalves remained in Viamão. Closing the siege of Porto Alegre, he sought to draw the enemy to an encounter whose result in open field could not be doubtful to him, in view of the numerical superiority of his people, although there was inferiority of arms. The position, however, was already becoming dangerous for him. The imperialists were reinforcing the garrison of Porto Alegre, where Bento Manoel had just arrived. Bento Gonçalves could no longer hope anything from the fortune of a pitched battle. The news of the proclamation of Jaguarão called him to easier contact with the companions of the countryside; thus he resolved to direct himself there, ascending the Jacuí by the left bank, crossing the Caí, and making junction with Domingos Crescêncio, who belonged to the column of the right and who was to bring him four hundred men. By this means he would become fit to offer combat to the imperialists, increasing the number of his men and seeking other resources that were already lacking to him in Viamão. The republican column set itself in march after incorporating itself with Onofre's brigade and, without being disturbed, crossed the Caí and made for the Jacuí, whose right bank Crescêncio was already approaching.

Bento Manoel watched these movements. He distributed spies along the whole road Bento Gonçalves had to travel, and was informed with security and promptness of all his steps. As soon as he knew that the Caí had been

crossed and that therefore the republican chief would no longer return, he hastened to take the lead before him. He embarked forces superior to one thousand men on the ships of the flotilla commanded by Grenfell and with them ascended the river. On 2 October he disembarked his men and took position in front of the republicans at a distance of little more than cannon shot. He furnished all the passages, leaving free only the road that leads to the bottom of a pocket, or *rincão*, as in Rio Grande it is called, formed by a pronounced curve of the great river.

There lies the small island of Fanfa, near another called Leão. The river broadens sensibly and, in consequence, diminishes in depth. By this fact, and because there is a good port on the left bank, although on the right there is not a corresponding one, passage is easy by rafts and floats, which can be driven from one side to the other by pole. Bento Manoel was as perspicacious in the choice of this point as Bento Gonçalves was little shrewd. The republican did not count on Grenfell's gunboats. He imagined that, once the branch of the river was gained and the column transferred to the island, he could easily fire upon the imperialists who approached the bank, while at the same time he would go crossing by the opposite side the other branch and disembarking on the left bank, where Crescêncio was. He moved on the night of the 2nd toward the bank; ordered rafts hastily built for the transport of the force; established a battery of three pieces and a howitzer, garrisoned by all the infantry, which amounted to little more than two hundred men, upon an eminence that dominates the *rincão*, with the aim of avoiding an alarm

in the rear at the moment of passage; upon the bank he ordered three pieces placed.

On the morning of the 3rd Grenfell's gunboats appeared before the island. The battery on the bank opened fire against them, and Grenfell feigned retreat. Suspicious, Bento Gonçalves ordered the passage halted, and the whole day he was in critical indecision and anxiety, without determining himself either to advance or to retreat. Advancing, he might be victim of the gunboats; retreating, he would have to engage a combat of doubtful result with Bento Manoel, besides which he would lose the junction with Crescêncio, who was already on the other side at the place called Charqueada. Indecision was always Bento Gonçalves's weak side. If he had resolutely abandoned the river bank, retreating and forcing one of Bento Manoel's garrisons, he would at least have avoided the loss of a great part of his column, if not of all of it. He resolved, however, upon the worst counsel: the naval force having disappeared, he ordered the interrupted passage recommenced, causing a great part of the troop to be transported during the night to the island of Fanfa.

Bento Manoel, affecting not to dispose of sufficient force, entertained during the whole day of the 3rd a disheartened artillery fire against the strong position of the eminence, while he organized ambushes and secretly sent four hundred infantrymen to the point of the island, determining for them the exact moment when they should attack.

At dawn on the 4th the battle broke out. Bento Manoel ordered Colonel of Legion Gabriel Gomes Lisboa to make

his men set foot on land and attack the battery of the eminence. Lisboa charged with impetus, animated by the immense superiority of number. The battery received the charge, sending it a fog of bullets; but, enveloped by numbers, it was dismantled and conquered. The three pieces with the howitzer fell into the hands of the imperialists. Of the garrison, some died, others were made prisoners, and the greater part gained the bank in confusion. There a raft was waiting: closely pricked by the aggressors, the fugitives threw themselves onto it with great violence. The fragile craft, unable to float with so great a weight, sank into the waters. It was a horrible whirl: some drowned, others crossed the channel swimming, many interrupted, already near the port of salvation, by fatigue or by enemy bullets. Of those who remained upon the bank, those who did not succumb to imperialist steel plunged into the woods.

Bento Manoel then ordered four pieces to be aimed upon the bank and to sweep the island with grapeshot. At the same time Grenfell's gunboats came bow-on toward the narrow redoubt and vomited upon it steady volleys of projectiles. The position of the republicans could not have been more afflictive. The convergent fires from the river and from land would have crushed them at the first burst had they not been protected by the trees and banks of the island. Suddenly the fire ceased on one side and the other at the same time, and an unexpected charge by one of the flanks startled the men on the island. It was the four hundred infantrymen. There the deadliest combat was joined. Recovered from the first fright, the

republicans repelled the charge almost exclusively with edged weapons. The imperialist Carlos José Ribeiro da Costa, lieutenant colonel of the national guard, who commanded the assault, was mortally wounded and ordered withdrawal, with great losses. But the republicans were exhausted; they feared that their island would be transformed into an island of corpses, although until then few had fallen, thanks to the natural defense.

At the same time Bento Manoel understood how difficult it would be to reduce them by force. He wrote to Bento Gonçalves, asking him to capitulate; the latter asked him under what conditions he accepted the capitulation. Bento Manoel replied that he would leave all free, once they surrendered their arms, and that he would have the same procedure also with Crescêncio's brigade if it presented itself within four days, and with the forces of Jaguarão and Pelotas within fifteen, all revolutionaries being required to recognize the lawful government of the province and of Brazil. Bento Gonçalves asked him to send these conditions in writing. Bento Manoel agreed. Then they capitulated.

The imperialists killed during the whole battle one hundred and twenty enemies, wounded a greater number, and received fifteen pieces of artillery, between those taken in combat and those delivered by virtue of the capitulation, with some more arms and munitions. One republican, before abandoning the island, ashamed to deliver the weapons with which he had fought, threw them into the water. Many imitated this conduct, so that the imperialists

received few hand weapons. The victors had, according to their official report, forty dead, among them a lieutenant, José Egydio Rodarte.

The rest of the day and part of the following passed in transporting the men who had capitulated from the island to the bank. Bento Manoel did not prevent those who came out from withdrawing, and to those who wished it he gave safe-conduct. With Bento Gonçalves and other officers, however, his procedure was not the same. When this colonel had to cross the river to come to an understanding with Crescêncio, the imperialist chief opposed it, and on that same afternoon of the 5th ordered him arrested and remitted to Porto Alegre, with Onofre, Zambicari, and others.

It is astonishing that a fact as clear as that of the capitulation of Fanfa has been until today controverted, many sustaining that Bento Gonçalves surrendered at discretion, did not capitulate, and advancing that there was never proof of the existence of such capitulation. The truth is that, in view of what occurred afterward, it seems that both chiefs dealt with perfidy, Bento Gonçalves losing any scruple before an enemy who had none; but the traitor was only Bento Manoel, or rather the government, because there are those who maintain that Bento Manoel became displeased with the procedure that the government afterward had toward the vanquished.

Those who understand that there was no capitulation argue thus: The republicans were enclosed on an island, without possibility of salvation; Bento Manoel did not

have any advantage in proposing conditions to them, because he had them secure: on the river was a flotilla; on land an army much superior in number. The premises are true, but they prove nothing. If it is true that the republicans were enclosed, it is no less certain that for defense they occupied an excellent position, which was the island covered with woods, whence they fired without being seen and where they could fortify themselves and make use of the eleven pieces of artillery they possessed with abundant munitions. Defeat would be certain, but it would be sold at a high price. If those on land wished to force them by means of siege, they either had to place themselves on the bank, whence they would easily be shot down, or they had to remain at a safe distance, giving occasion for the six hundred men on the island to leap upon the beach and open a road for flight, avoiding the persecutions they held as certain if they fell into the hands of the enemy. Besides, it was not only these six hundred men on the island who interested the imperialists: on the other bank was Crescêncio with four hundred, completely free of danger, and it seems Bento Manoel must have had every advantage in disarming them, even because, crossing the river lower or higher, they could attack him in the rear while those on the island charged in front. Consider further that Bento Manoel also proposed the disarmament of the forces of Pelotas and Jaguarão. This as to the possibility of the fact; as to its reality, the documents are more eloquent than the reasonings. Bento Manoel's own official report to the minister of war sheds much light upon the subject. It says: "And, because the force of Crescêncio,

existing on the other side and in view, had to surrender its arms, the same chief Bento Gonçalves offered to carry out the disarmament immediately, or on the following day, to which I assented; but, as I was warned that he wished to take his horses, servants, and baggage, I suspected that his aim was to evade himself with that force and go join others, for which reason I had it proposed to him to send an officer of his confidence, who would go accompanied by another from this force. Bento Gonçalves sent his brother-in-law Manoel Antunes, who took his slave and trunk, and as soon as he arrived on the other side began to declaim against the government and legal authorities of the province; and when at night the officer who accompanied him was dispatched, he declared to him that he was not coming. Crescêncio answered Bento Gonçalves confusedly, demanding that he appear there to carry out the disarmament and that he take with him some officers of this force to witness the act; but that same night of the 5th he withdrew, hastily lifting the camp.”

A little further on Bento Manoel says that he is convinced that Bento Gonçalves, “only to save his life or avoid being imprisoned, had submitted to the disarmament of the force enclosed on the island.” All this proves with some evidence that Bento Gonçalves, despite his desperate position, did not give himself up as prisoner, but capitulated, accepted conditions. What conditions were these? The following document shows it abundantly, and at the same time gives the final and sovereign blow in the question: “I receive as brothers and pledge that they shall be free from persecutions, in conformity with the orders of the

government of Brazil, the individuals who present themselves and recognize the lawful government of the same Brazil and of the province: those who are on this island this very day, those who are at Charqueada within four days, and those of Jaguarão and Pelotas within the term of fifteen days, included among these all the chiefs who have accompanied Colonel Bento Gonçalves da Silva and the same colonel, delivering all the artillery park, armaments, and munitions at the occasion of their presenting themselves. Camp at the port of Fanfa, 4 October 1836. Bento Manoel Ribeiro, commander of arms.”

Bento Gonçalves carried this document with him when he was put into the *Presiganga* of Porto Alegre. There he gave it to be read to Deputy Antônio Álvares Pereira Coruja, who was also imprisoned; the latter asked him to make a copy, and it is from this copy, whose authenticity Mr. Coruja, still living, guarantees, that such interesting testimony is extracted here. What makes the treason more flagrant is that Bento Manoel did not require that all the republicans obey the government in order to consider free from persecutions those who presented themselves. Nevertheless, Bento Gonçalves and some valiant companions were shut in the dungeons.

The prisoners of Fanfa having been installed in the *Presiganga*, Lieutenant Antônio Pedro de Abreu, brother of Francisco Pedro, who will play a prominent role in this war, received orders to put them in irons. Abreu refused to place shackles on Onofre and Bento Gonçalves, who was his relative; but the unfortunate Zambicari, who accom-

panied Bento Gonçalves in the capacity of secretary and had been captured with him after the capitulation, was loaded with irons, chiefly because, Abreu said, he was a foreigner and meddled in the affairs of the country.

Later these prisoners were removed to Rio, with some of those who had been captured in the restoration of Porto Alegre. Bento Gonçalves, Onofre, Zambicari, Pedro Boticário, José Calvet, Marciano Ribeiro, and others arrived there on 7 November, and were almost all shut in the strong house of the fortress of Santa Cruz. Those who were not soldiers obtained habeas corpus and, although later persecuted by virtue of proceedings instituted in Porto Alegre, succeeded, by hiding, in returning to the province. Dr. Marciano Ribeiro, already returned, died about a year later in São Gabriel. Bento Gonçalves and Zambicari were afterward transferred to the fortress of Laje. We shall see later what happened to the three colonels Bento Gonçalves, Onofre, and Corte Real, who had already been found by the first two in Santa Cruz. As for the ex-count Zambicari, he never again appeared in Rio Grande. For a long time he remained in his prison; later, with much labor, he obtained in his favor the intervention of the Italian consul, was released, and departed for Europe, where he still took active part in the events of 1848. Of those who remained in the prisons of Porto Alegre, some soon freed themselves, others remained for a long time, and some succumbed in prison, among whom Vicente Ferreira Gomes, who died after ill treatment aggravated the stomach illness from which he suffered.

Chapter VIII

Piratini

The fatal event of Fanfa could not have come more opportunely to crush and destroy the nascent republic. Nevertheless, no fact contributed more to making patent the tenacity of the republicans, so often and so brilliantly proved on later occasions. The fervor with which the struggle resumed and recrudesced well evidenced that the sentiment which moved these men was unanimous and concordant, spontaneous and natural, that they were dragged by convictions, well or ill founded, it matters not, but that certainly they did not follow the impositions of a caudillo, because the absence of this caudillo did not suffocate, but rather encouraged and impelled the primitive impetus.

To the painful and difficult situation that loomed, it was necessary to oppose exceptional energy and activity. Netto was the first to summon the courage of his men, casting to them on 30 October this cry: "The reverse we have suffered is great; but it is only one in the circle of so many triumphs; redouble your valor, and we shall conquer." He addressed himself to all the influential men of the movement, encouraged the faint-hearted, combined with Lima e Silva, and finally all agreed that definitive character should be given to the republic, organizing its government and thus constituting a center for operations. They resolved that a meeting should be held in the town of Piratini, where, better defended from the enemy, they

could deliberate. A precise day was set for this congress, and all made their way there in time.

Lima e Silva, with his wound seriously aggravated, left Pelotas on 20 October and arrived at Piratini on 2 November. He had been commander of arms when Rio Grande was a province; the republic having been erected, his office came to an end. But on the road the troop that accompanied him acclaimed him general and commander-in-chief of the republican army. This post was not contested to him, and the future government accepted it.

From every side the people converged on Piratini. Many came from consideration of personal safety, and all from the desire to take part in the constitution of the republic: innumerable military chiefs, those whom revolutions improve and who are for that very reason the best, because they are children of necessity and not of the favors of a government; estancia owners and wealthy merchants from every place, who sacrificed fortune and future so as not to sacrifice the opinions they had sustained in better times; men of all classes and professions, nationals and foreigners, lawyers, physicians, priests, artists, some who took up arms and entered the ranks as soldiers, others who stripped themselves of their goods to aid the common effort. All, arriving simultaneously by diverse and opposite roads, filled within a few days the small town and transformed the usual sullen quiet into the agitated murmur of a deliberative congress.

The municipal council became the center of all the elaboration. All the councilmen were republicans. On 5

November they met in preparatory session. They were: Vicente Lucas de Oliveira, president, Francisco Moreira da Silva Verde, Antônio Correia da Silva, João Antônio de Moraes, José Pereira da Silva Caçório, and Serafim José da Silveira. Councilman Velleda, being ill, could not appear. The president took the floor: he declared that the session had as its object to treat of proclaiming in that municipality independence and the republic, an act necessary not only because it was in accord with the opinion of the majority of the Rio-Grandense people, but because it was the last resource the patriots had in face of the persecution of the government of Brazil. He therefore proposed independence and the republic, with the clause, however, that the new state might “bind itself by the ties of federation to those provinces of Brazil that adopted the same system of government.” He further proposed that the election of the governing personnel be treated with urgency, and that in this sense the opinion of the general-in-chief of the army be consulted, inviting him together to come before the council to take the oath of his office and of fidelity to the republic.

The council unanimously approved these measures. A deputation of three members took to the general the consultation of which it was a question, while the session remained suspended awaiting his reply. Lima e Silva answered that his grave illness did not permit him to go take the oath to which he had been invited, for which, moreover, he would be at the council’s disposal when he improved, or even at his residence from that moment. He was of the opinion that citizen João José de Oliveira

Guimarães should be elected president of the republic; and, understanding that in so grave a business, besides civilians, the officers and soldiers of the army ought to have a vote, he desired that the day appointed for the election be communicated to him. The session was closed, another being convoked for the following day.

The council met again on the 6th. It was agreed that this should be the day of the election of the first magistrates of the republic. Within and outside the simple and modest enclosure there was gathered a great mass of people. From the general aspect of this assembly, which for the first time was seen after the revolutionary cry, there breathed an accent of profound solemnity, which shone through the countenance of each of those congregated. There was Colonel Antônio de Souza Netto, in the fullness of his glorious life, still revealing clearly in his face the traces of the physical beauty with which he was endowed and those chivalrous tendencies which made of him, even into old age, a gallant, a soldier, and a patriot, in everything extreme and ardent. At his side sat the noble old José Gomes de Vasconcellos Jardim, who took no account of the weight of years and the cares of a great fortune in order to hurl himself into the defense of his ideas, even amid the hazards of a revolution. Near him was Domingos José de Almeida, grave and pensive, as if there already passed through his thought the effective direction he was to impress upon the new fatherland being created. There was also Joaquim Pedro Soares, lieutenant colonel, adjutant general and commander of the 1st corps of lancers, those semi-barbarians redeemed from slavery, whom their brav-

ery guided to combat with the impetuosity of a torrent; Major Joaquim Teixeira Nunes, his immediate subordinate, rare and legitimate type of the true gaúcho, whose daring one day astonished Garibaldi himself, the man whom fame consecrated as the bravest of this century; Antônio Vicente da Fontoura, cultured spirit and great talent; Dr. Antônio Pereira de Siqueira Leitão, Major José Mariano de Mattos, Captain Manoel de Macedo Brum da Silveira, the lawyer José Pinheiro de Ulhoa Cintra, Lieutenant Colonel José Alves de Moraes, Father Miguel Justino Garcez Moncada, and a great number of other patriots, who came to lend their presence and their vote for the installation of this state to which they would later sacrifice blood and life. Strange commotions must have agitated the souls of these men at the supreme moment when they were to detach themselves from subjection to the old fatherland and assume the responsibility of independence. Fatal errors by those to whom the direction of that fatherland was entrusted had precipitated them outside the roof under which they were born; the idea of the greatness of the struggle that must fatally follow, of the sacrifices that had to be confronted and conquered, of the privations and misery that accompany civil wars; the remembrance that, to triumph, it was necessary to subdue the resistance of a vast empire, twenty times larger than the rebel portion; all this and a thousand other conjectures assailed the mind of the assembly and produced, by the concentration of spirits, a majestic and solemn silence.

In the midst of this silence the president rose and, indicating the aim of the assembly, asked the opinions of

Netto and Almeida on the possibility of carrying out the election at once. Both understood that it should be treated immediately. The council then wrote officially to General Lima e Silva, and, the answer having arrived, the people began to deposit in the urn their suffrages. Numerous as those present were, they were nevertheless few to create the chief of a state; but circumstances justify everything, and in few revolutions will similar matters have been handled with the regularity and independence that reigned in this one. The president chosen was Bento Gonçalves, a citizen who was absent, in the hands of the enemy, with no possibility of exercising pressure upon the electors. Militarism influenced nothing: the opinion of the commander-in-chief of the little army was that the president should be another than the one named. Next were proclaimed elected as vice-presidents the citizens Antônio Paulo da Fontoura, José Mariano de Mattos, Domingos José de Almeida, and Ignacio José de Oliveira Guimarães. Of these only the second was a soldier, who had for himself the recommendation of being a man of vast knowledge, so much so that later, the republic extinct, the government of Brazil found him worthy of the office of minister of war. The chosen president was absent; it did not suit the new state to organize itself with the vacillation of interim governments. It was therefore deliberated that an effective substitute for Bento Gonçalves should be elected. The election for this new office fell upon the citizen José Gomes de Vasconcellos Jardim. On the same day the new authorities took the oath. All of them had been voted with the preliminary condition of depositing power in the

bosom of the constituent assembly, convoking it as soon as the special circumstances of the state permitted. Gomes Jardim took office and named his ministry, distributing the portfolios thus: Domingos José de Almeida, minister of finance, accumulating the portfolio of the interior; José Mariano, minister of war and navy; Ulhoa Cintra, minister of justice and foreign affairs.

Thus was definitively inaugurated, on 6 November, the Rio-Grandense Republic. What I have thus far narrated is no more than the prologue of the tragedy whose scenes will still unfold through more than eight years of harsh war. We shall soon see what internal organization the republic received, by what manner it prospered, prolonged itself, declined, and perished, without ever staining, but rather aggrandizing and exalting to the last moment, the honor of the generous people that erected and sustained it.

End of Volume I.

Appendices

Appendix A

Manifesto of Bento Gonçalves

Compatriots, The love of order and liberty, to which I have consecrated myself since my infancy, tore me from the enjoyment of the pleasures of private life to run with you to the salvation of our beloved fatherland. I saw arbitrariness enthroned and could no longer be deaf to your just clamors; you asked the cooperation of my arm and of the

arms that accompany me, and I flew to the capital in order to help you shake off the yoke which, with the hand of an inept administrator, a retrograde and anti-national faction had imposed upon you.

Compatriots! Your vows and your just demands are already satisfied. That authority has fallen whose mantle covered the attempts of perverse men who have conducted this deserving province to the edge of the precipice. You ran to arms after having exhausted all the means that prudence and love of order suggested to you, not to destroy, but rather to consolidate the sacred Constitution we swore; not to avenge yourselves for the outrages daily inflicted upon you by the leaders of an anti-national party, but rather to guarantee the liberties of the fatherland from their attacks, all the more terrible because they were exercised under the shadow of the Constitutional Charter. You ran, finally, to arms to sustain in their purity the political principles which led us to the ever-memorable seventh of April, glorious day of our regeneration and total independence.

The result of your noble enterprise could not be doubtful, since it was demanded by justice and by opinion, that queen of the universe, whose power is irresistible. You triumphed, free Brazilians! And with your decision and your triumph you gave proof that you are worthy of the benefits of liberty; you made patent the noble sentiments of nationality that inflame your breasts; you proved, finally, that your brow will never bend to the heavy yoke of arbitrariness.

These motives and these sentiments, which all truly Brazilian hearts share with you, will justify your conduct in the eyes of the most rigid censors of popular movements. Let us hasten, then, to manifest to our brothers, inhabitants of the other provinces of the Brazilian union, the foundations of our complaints and of our fears. Let Brazil know that the twentieth of September 1835 was the inevitable consequence of a bad and odious administration; and that we had no other object and proposed to ourselves no other end than to restore the empire of law, removing from among us an inept and factious administrator, sustaining the throne of our young monarch and the integrity of the Empire.

Yes, compatriots, let us give to Brazil, which at this moment has its eyes fixed upon us, this manifestation, all the more sincere and prompt as greater is the duty in which we find ourselves of dispelling the fears with which our enemies wished to alarm it, accusing us of sustaining views of disunion and republic. Unfortunately in this province, as in the others of the Empire, there exists a retrograde faction opposed by principles and interests to the new order of things, and implacable enemy of all those who profess decided love for the liberties of the fatherland. This anti-national party, supported by Marshal Barreto, whose immoderate ambition and unpopular principles are well enough known, allowed its fatal influence to be felt in all the presidencies prior to that of Mr. Braga; but it never dared to show itself so shamelessly as in this last period.

Deceived were the hopes of the friends of our fatherland, who rejoiced to see, for the first time, one of its sons raised to the first dignity of the province! How many benefits were to be expected! How many evils prevented! But a sad fatality willed the contrary.

The ineptitude that Mr. Braga from the beginning showed for so elevated an office, and the versatility of his character, favored the designs of the perverse, who found in him the instrument of their rancor against the free, and in the power annexed to the presidency the means of satisfying their ignoble vengeance. No one ignores the events of the night of 24 October of last year and of the consecutive days; no one ignores how the anti-national party, arming mercenaries and foreigners, occupied militarily the military stores of the capital and threatened with warlike apparatus the peaceful citizens who on that night were celebrating with patriotic songs the salutary reforms of our social pact. Custom authorized the celebration, order presided over the steps of a people that surrendered itself to pleasure, and at its head marched the justices of the peace of the districts it traversed; but despite this, little was lacking for the thunder of cannon and the cry of death to succeed the festive sounds and the expansion of satisfied nationality.

Those threats, that unusual armament, was it not perhaps the first insult committed against our nationality? Did it not deserve a prompt and exemplary punishment? Could not the powerful arm of an irritated people execute it? It could, yes, but the patriots, friends of order, did not wish

it; they suffocated in their breasts their just resentments; they expected measures and justice from their highest authority. Vain hopes! While the volcano of passions threatened to burn the capital, what did Mr. Braga do? He intoxicated himself, with sorrow we say it, he intoxicated himself with pleasure in the city of Rio Grande amid feasts and banquets, leaving in those thorny circumstances the helm of the state delivered to the caprice of his brother, Mr. Pedro Rodrigues Fernandes Chaves, a turbulent and factious youth, and the very one who directed and gave impulse to the party that at that moment terrified the capital. The news, ever more terrifying, which he received from this point seemed to awaken him for an instant from his lethargy; he then called me and, in the name of the fatherland, conjured me that, using all my influence, I should go maintain public quiet: you are the only one, he said to me, who can free the province from the evils that threaten it; fly, calm, reconcile, and restrain the fury of the people; avoid every effusion of blood; assure it that I shall return promptly, and it will applaud my justice.

Compatriots! The name of the fatherland has never sounded in vain in my ears, and I have always lent myself voluntarily to render it my services. I believed the deceitful words of Mr. Braga and flew to your side. Docile, you heard my words of peace, you stayed the arm already ready to discharge the mortal blow upon your aggressors, and through me you trusted anew in your president. But who would believe it! The perfidious man had deceived me, and my patriotism served him only as instrument to deceive you also and disarm you. How can such conduct

be justified in the highest authority, which ought to hear no other voice than that of justice and have no other views than those of the good of the people it governs? If the ex-president had desired the well-being and tranquillity of the province, he would not have abandoned the place that the law entrusted to him; he would have hastened promptly to the point that threatened conflagration, and the punishment of the factious would have satisfied the justice of an outraged people.

No, certainly, he did not have in view the good of the fatherland when he carried from Rio Grande confusion and discord to every corner of the province; when on his return to the capital he approved all the most senseless and criminal acts committed by his lieutenant, Pedro Rodrigues Fernandes Chaves; when he drove from himself his old friends, the defenders of free institutions; when, ungrateful to my zeal for the reestablishment of public tranquillity, he dared call me caudillo of malefactors and revolutionary.

Madman! If I had wished to raise the standard of rebellion, what better opportunity than the exaltation in which spirits found themselves? What motive more plausible than the insult made to nationality? What means more powerful than the blank letters that his past fear, and more than all the certainty that I would not abuse them, had entrusted to me? But he was already deaf to the austere language of truth and lent his ears only to the base flatteries and perfidious counsels of a party that wished to see him involved in its interests and accomplice in its crimes, in

order to assure itself of impunity and of the triumph of retrograde principles. Mr. Braga ceased to be administrator of a free people from the moment that he substituted the spirit of faction for the empire of law, and from that instant the people ceased to respect him. Without moral force, without opinion, a government subsists only by demoralization, intrigue, and oppression, and this was the path full of precipices into which Mr. Braga cast himself. You saw him, Rio-Grandenses, supporting at court with his authority the most shameful intrigues of Marshal Barreto, to ruin those whose enlightenment and patriotism crossed his ambitious and despotic plans, while with his power in this city he authorized the desired vengeance. The first blow struck against liberty leads insensibly and inevitably to all the others: it is a door opened to arbitrariness, and once it enters, no one can foresee at what point it will stop. Compatriots! You witnessed this truth, and the citizens most decided for the cause of the people were the target of a systematic persecution; there were lavished offices upon the most unpopular men, upon those most indicated as professing the most retrograde and anti-national principles; the right of petition guaranteed by our Constitution was disregarded, and petitioners treated as seditious; the prisons were filled with patriots, and the whole province was involved in legal proceedings and criminal complaints; demoralization was introduced into the national infantry guard in order to disperse it, and Lieutenant Colonel Silvano José Monteiro de Araújo e Paula was arbitrarily suspended from his command, his crime being his unshakable patriotism; a praetorian guard

was created under the name of national cavalry guard to guard the city; with enormous expenses and detriment to the public treasury, the valiant battalion of chasseurs no. 8 was sent to the distant frontiers of Missions; the company of chasseurs that was in the town of Jaguarão by order of the Regency was removed to Bagé, doubling without necessity or plausible motive the expenses, through the costly transport of provisions, munitions, and baggage to points so distant.

Silva Tavares, captain of the extinct 2nd Line, was named commander of the frontier of Rio Grande in spite of the instructions of the Regency of 8 March 1834, thus subjecting to the nullity and wickedness of this perverse man a countless number of valiant and seasoned chiefs. Mr. Bento Manoel Ribeiro, veteran of our warriors, was removed from the command of the frontier of Rio Pardo and replaced by Lieutenant Colonel of the same extinct 2nd Line, José Antônio Martins, whose only title is the particular enmity he consecrates to Colonel Bento Manoel Ribeiro and his belonging to the faction of Marshal Barreto. Finally, under the presidency of Mr. Braga we saw the temple of Themis converted into the forge of the most unjust persecutions; we saw citizens armed against citizens; we saw deportations; we saw the sacred guarantee of habeas corpus twice violated in the person of the honorable patriot Major José Marianno de Mattos; and finally we saw unpunished the scandalous introduction of Africans and of copper coin, terrible scourges of this ill-fated province.

With these and many other outrages, which for brevity I omit, the demands of Marshal Barreto, of Pedro Chaves, and of the retrograde faction were satisfied. But it was necessary to cover persecutions with the mantle of public utility; it was necessary to legalize acts perpetrated against the opinion of the great majority of the province. The epoch of the installation of our provincial assembly arrived, and the president's address tore away the mask with which he covered a hypocritical and lowly policy: the most atrocious calumny was uttered in its bosom with haughtiness and daring, and the province trembled for its tranquillity and existence, hearing the voice of its highest authority reveal to it a conspiracy whose aim was to dismember it from the great Brazilian family and accuse as authors of so nefarious a project the most conspicuous defenders of the liberties of the fatherland, those who at all times had valorously exposed their lives and shed their blood in defense of the integrity of the Empire. Senseless project! The mortal blow that the ex-president premeditated striking against the honor and well-merited opinion of his adversaries reverberated against himself! Thanks be given to the energy of the generous patriot deputies of the opposition! They advocated the cause of innocence against the apparatus of power and against the league of the factious who sat on the benches of our provincial assembly. Their noble and austere language terrified calumny, pursued the calumniator to his last trenches, and obtained the glory of obliging him to the most abject retraction and of tranquillizing the province by showing it that the revealed conspiracy did not exist. A general

clamor of indignation succeeded that of the fear which had been wished to be instilled, and this just indignation finished making Mr. Braga's authority contemptible.

After this defeat, who would have dared to remain in the eminent place that had been dishonored? But Mr. Braga was no longer free to retreat even if he had wished it; blinded by the retrograde party, by his personal commitments, and by the fatal influence of his brother, always ready to incite him to every class of violence, he persisted in the presidency and continued his oppressive and anti-national march. The factious party in its very rage found new forces to attempt new enterprises against the interests of the majority of this province, which in its delirium it treated as seditious and anarchic. It believed that its position was still the strongest despite public opinion, which was contrary to it. The most important places were entrusted to members of its faction, and the greater part of the influential men of the liberal party neutralized; it counted a large number of factious men in the bosom of the Provincial Representation; it counted on the support of its leader, Marshal Barreto, who dared promise to draw armed force from a neighboring state to suffocate any attempt of free men; liberty of the press served it as vehicle to spread its retrograde and unpopular doctrines, to attack with the gall of calumny reputations acquired by a long series of services rendered to the fatherland, to sow discord and divide in order to reign; it counted on the national treasury to buy proselytes and supply the expenses of a prodigal and senseless administration; and

finally it counted on corrupt and prevaricating magistrates to legalize unjust persecutions and the most arbitrary acts.

Such were the elements upon which the past administration counted, and could free Brazilians suffer any longer its heavy and immoral yoke, and leave to their children the sad example of triumphant arbitrariness? The chalice of bitterness was not yet full, but it did not delay in becoming so. Not content with presenting in its filthy periodicals our honorable and industrious countrymen as buried in the darkness of the grossest ignorance, as inept to defend their political interests, and with calling them barbarians, paupers, and proletarians, the retrograde party projected overburdening them with a new and onerous tax of ten mil-réis annually upon each square league; a tax contrary to the principles of political economy, an unjust and cruel tax, because it falls upon capital and not upon product; unjust and cruel, finally, because it weighs unequally by reason of the greater or lesser fertility of our fields.

Vain were the efforts of the liberal deputies to oppose so oppressive a law; it passed despite sound reason and the well-being of our comprovincials. Mr. Braga, who by article 16 of the law of reforms was authorized to deny his sanction to any law when he understood it not to suit the interests of the province, and who could consequently, suspending its execution, prevent the evils that it dragged after itself, far from wishing to do so, from the outset sanctioned it and ordered it fulfilled. Did he perhaps lack reasons on which to found his refusal? Certainly not. A son of this province, he possessed all the knowledge

necessary to judge the tax impolitic and unjust; but the spirit of faction directed all the acts of his fatal administration. The discontent this new tax would excite, and that its execution would occasion a prompt and general rising, must necessarily have been foreseen. The factious therefore had to devise a way of conjuring the tempest by providing themselves with an armed force devoted to their will and commanded by chiefs of their faction.

In vain would they seek this force among the valiant veterans! Those who had fought for the liberties of the fatherland could never be converted into executioners of their fellow citizens, could never unsheathe the sword to cut the throats of their fathers, their sons, and their friends! No. The soldiers of regenerated Brazil shed their blood to defend the fatherland, and not to oppress it. Would they seek this force among the deserving national guards of the countryside? Certainly not; these are the most vexed and oppressed by the tax.

Where then would they seek this force? It costs to say it! In the creation of a police corps of seven hundred men, in the organization of a corps of janissaries who with the points of their swords would make the most unpopular and oppressive measures executable. We can assure, for the honor of this province, that this revolting project would never have passed in our assembly if it had been proposed and discussed with the formalities of style; but cabal and surprise made them obtain what in no other way they would ever have obtained. This corps was created by a simple amendment of Mr. Manoel Felizardo when the

provincial budget law was being discussed, authorizing at the same time the president to make its regulation! Such a manner of creating a battalion found the strongest opposition from our liberal deputies, and although that amendment had been maliciously signed by deputies partisan to the factious administration and by some others who, deceived, lent themselves to the iniquitous designs of Messrs. Chaves and Felizardo, although, we say, that new species of signed petition, until now unknown in parliamentary debates, represented the majority of the assembly and was equivalent to a vote before discussion, it passed by only two votes. And this formidable cohort, whose expenses would have absorbed the enormous sum of two hundred contos de réis annually, was in fact made and organized by Mr. Braga, who in this way assumed the two powers.

So many acts of arbitrariness and so many outrages in a people that prides itself on being free had finally to tire its sufferings. The disquiet which from the first months of Mr. Braga's presidency had spread through the greater part of this province, and which prudence and love of order had so many times calmed, appeared again, as if kindled by electric virtue, and became general.

To the alert observer our fatherland appeared as a sick man whom an ardent fever mortifies, and who alternately hopes and fears that the crisis tormenting him will give him health or death. In vain, compatriots, did you seek a means of salvation; it was in the Charter, but in those moments the Charter was a dead letter; the legal avenues

were obstructed to you; the apathy of the central government did not let the smallest hope of improvement shine through; evils already threatened you close at hand; any delay was dangerous; and force was about to dominate you, and you destroyed force with force.

We fulfilled, Rio-Grandenses, a sacred duty in repelling the first attempts at arbitrariness in our dear fatherland; it will thank you, and all Brazil will applaud your patriotism and the justice that armed your arm to depose an inept and factious authority and reestablish the empire of law. Compatriots, to the glory of having in other times been your companion on the battlefields and having led you against your external enemies, I shall add the still nobler and more enduring glory of having helped free it from its internal enemies and saving it from the evils of anarchy.

The government of faction has disappeared from our political scene; order finds itself reestablished. With this triumph of liberal principles my ambition is satisfied, and in the repose of private life, to which alone I aspire, I shall enjoy the pleasure of seeing you enjoy the benefits of an enlightened, liberal government conformable to the wishes of the majority of the province. Respecting the oath we rendered to our sacred code, to the constitutional throne, and to the preservation of the integrity of the Empire, you will prove to the enemies of our quiet and happiness that you know how to prefer the yoke of law to that of its infractors, and that at the same time you never forget that you are administrators of the best patrimony of the generations that must succeed you, that this

patrimony is liberty, and that you are under obligation to defend it at the cost of your blood and of your existence. The execration of our children will fall upon our ashes if by our demoralization and cowardice we transmit to them this sacred deposit spoiled and corrupted; and their blessings will accompany us to the sepulcher if we leave them examples of virtue and patriotism.

Porto Alegre, 25 September 1835.

Bento Gonçalves da Silva.

Appendix B

Excerpt from a Proclamation by Bento Gonçalves

Compatriots, comrades, friends, For the last time, perhaps, he has the honor of addressing his countrymen, and all the men friendly to liberty who exist upon this blessed soil, your friend who, untiring in the hardships of war, has accompanied you in all the labors and privations since the memorable day on which he led you to the path of liberty for which you struggle, braving the power of the Empire without its having achieved more than to prolong the war for more than eight years: to recall in a brief sketch our conduct and that of the delegates of the imperial government from the beginning of the struggle to this date.

The war, compatriots, would have ended and peace would reign among us, if the government of Brazil had not despised all our propositions from the beginning of our glorious revolution. This was operated only so that we

might rid ourselves of the small tyrants who, supported by the first delegate of the government, enslaved us; which was made public in the manifesto I presented immediately after the majestic 20 September 1835.

You know that in it I made the then Regency of Brazil see that we were ready to accept the president whom, in place of the expelled one, that government should send us, once convinced of the justice that forced us to take such a step, demonstrated in the said manifesto. And so firm were we in fulfilling what I there expounded that the standard of the Empire was the one that fluttered among us; the cries of “Long live liberty, the constitution, the regency, the young emperor, and the general assembly” were those that resounded daily among our ranks, in feasts and in every corner of the province. But how did the regency answer us? By sending us a hostile and Machiavellian president, who, refusing to take possession of the government by the laws set forth in the constitution, seized it by illegal means and declared war on us, introducing dissension to divide us and, what is more, hiring foreigners with gold⁽¹⁾ to shed our blood! How legal are these means of defense!

- (1) What I affirm is justified by official letters of Dr. Antônio Fernandes Rodrigues Braga, then president of the province, addressed to Colonel Servando Gomes, commander of the department of Cerro Largo, and to Silva Tavares, who had emigrated there, offering two patacões per day to every Uruguayan who took up arms to invade the country. As a consequence, Colonel Albano de Oliveira immediately passed over

with a squadron that was undone at Pelotas in the first encounter. Those official letters are archived. B. Gonçalves.

From then on, you are witnesses that our cry of “Long live liberty, the constitution, the regency, the young emperor, and the general assembly,” with the pavilion raised, was answered with iron and fire. In this state of things it was necessary for us to abandon that standard and exchange the cry of “Long live the regency, the young emperor,” and so forth, for that of “Republic or death!” This was the heroic procedure of Brazilians with respect to the Portuguese government, and ours toward that of Brazil in a similar state.

A republican government, elected by the majority of the people, was established, and it still exists, despite that oligarchy which by misfortune still dominates Brazil.

Long live liberty! Long live the Republic! Long live the Brazilian Federation!

Bento Gonçalves da Silva.

N.B. This proclamation bears no date; but, referring elsewhere to the beginning of Caxias’s presidency, it must be from 1843.

Club Vinte de Setembro

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Note: By mistake, on line 10 of page 3, 5,000 was printed instead of 8,000 for the surface area of the province.

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Erratum

Page 3, line 10: instead of 5,000 read 8,000.